

IFL Sack Management System — User & IT Guide

Ibrahim Fibres Limited (IFL)

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About this guide

This guide covers the IFL Sack Management System (SMS): a web application that reports on sack and cone production from IFL's TP1 Line 3 / Unit 2 yarn spinning line, built for Ibrahim Fibres Limited (IFL).

Who this guide is for

Two audiences share this book:

- **IFL's IT staff**, who install SMS on the plant PC, connect it to the SQL Server databases, keep it running, back it up, and troubleshoot it. Chapters 1 to 6 and 8 to 10, and appendices A and B, are written for this reader.
- **Daily users** — the GM, managers and process engineers of IFL's process department. Chapter 7 walks through each screen. Chapter 11 answers the questions this audience asks most often.

Both audiences are technical. SMS was built for one department, not a mix of floor staff and management, so every screen is written in plain, direct language rather than simplified for a non-technical reader.

Conventions used in this guide

- Text shown in **bold** that is quoted from the screen itself — a button, a menu item, a column header — is copied exactly, including capitalisation.
- A shaded box like the one below is a command to type exactly as shown, or output to expect back:

```
example command or output
```

- A numbered step is followed by "**You should see: ...**", describing the result, and "**If it fails, see ...**", pointing at the relevant troubleshooting entry.
- ☐ marks a checklist item to tick off as it is confirmed.
- A blue box marked **Note:** adds useful context. An amber box marked **Warning:** flags something that can lose data or lock an account out if skipped.
- Placeholder paths use C:\sms for the install folder and C:\sms-backups for the backup folder — substitute the real folders IT chose during installation if they differ.

Note: Every screenshot in this guide was taken from a demonstration system fed by a plant simulator that generates realistic but entirely synthetic readings, not IFL's real production data. Every screen the simulator feeds shows this in the wording itself — the provenance label reads **Simulator** and a sentence on screen states that the figures shown are the simulator's, not the plant's. **The real, live installation will never show this banner or label** — it appears only because these screenshots come from a demonstration, not because it is a normal part of the application.

Quick start

This is the fast path for someone who already has the package, SQL Server Express, and Node installed, and just needs SMS running so it can be tested. Chapters 3 and 4 give the full, detailed version of every step below, including what to do if a step fails.

1. **Create the app database and its SQL logins.** Run `db\bootstrap\00_create_app_database.sql` against the app database server with `sqlcmd`, as described in section 4.3.
2. **Create .env.** Copy `.env.example` to `.env` in the package root and fill in the database connection details, the read-only IFL login, and the other keys described in section 6.1.
3. **Build, migrate, and create the first admin account.** Run `npm ci && npm run build`, then `npm run db:migrate`, then `node cli/dist/index.js user:create` with `--role=admin`, as described in section 4.5 and section 4.7.
4. **Start the services and connect to the plant for the first time.** Start the API and sync-worker services (directly, or as Windows services once NSSM is set up — section 4.9), then run the first sync, accept the source generation with `epoch:accept`, and confirm with `verify`, as described in section 4.11.
5. **Sign in.** Open the SMS web address in a browser and sign in with the admin account created in step 3.

How to know it works

- `GET /api/health` returns `"status": "ok"` (or an explainable `"degraded"` — see section 8).
- The **Health** screen turns green — its headline reads **Everything is healthy**. — within two sync passes of the plant connection being live.
- `node cli/dist/index.js verify` exits with no STOP lines and no weight mismatches.

If any of these do not hold, do not consider the installation finished — work through the relevant numbered installation step again before moving on to daily use.

1 How SMS works

1.1 The big picture

SMS is built from three long-running pieces, plus the app's own database. The plant's Siemens S7-1500 PLCs weigh every cone and every sack; a tag-acquisition layer IFL already runs writes those readings into two SQL Server databases (DATA_TP1U2 for weights and rejects, PDAS_TP1U2 for product/material master data). SMS never touches those databases except to read from them.

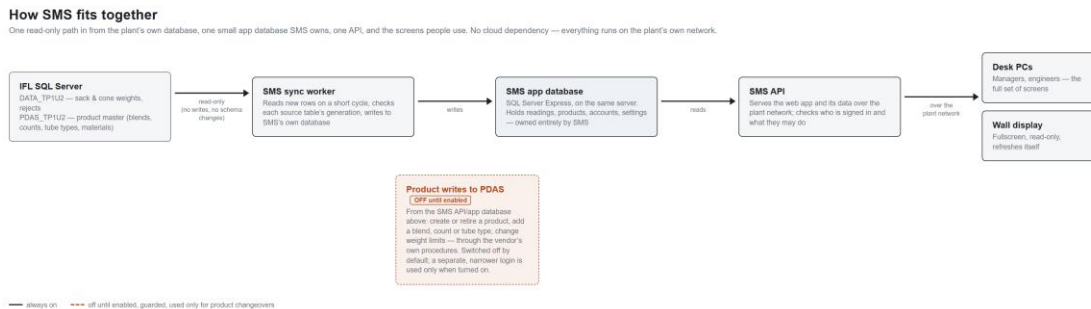


Figure 1 — SMS architecture: the sync worker reads IFL's SQL Server (read-only) on a short cycle and writes to SMS's own app database; the API reads that database and serves the desk PCs and the wall display over the plant network. Product writes to PDAS are shown as off until enabled. The command-line tool is not drawn.

- **The sync worker** is the only SMS process that connects to IFL's SQL Server, and it only ever reads. It runs on a schedule (every SYNC_INTERVAL_SECONDS, 60 seconds by default), pulls new rows, and writes them into SMS's own app database after resolving which source generation they belong to (see section 1.4).
- **The API** serves /api/* to the browser, and also serves the built web app itself when WEB_DIST is set — the normal production setup is one process doing both.
- **The CLI** (node cli/dist/index.js <command>) runs one-off operations: the first sync, verifying data against the source, listing and accepting source generations, creating accounts, and maintenance tasks. See Appendix B for the full command reference.
- **The app database** is SMS's own SQL Server Express database. It holds the canonical readings the sync worker has processed, plus everything SMS itself writes: accounts, sessions, the audit log, calibration adjustments, and the product timeline.

1.2 The ~18-minute lag

IFL's own acquisition layer writes a cone's row to the database about 18 minutes after the cone is actually weighed (measured: 909 seconds minimum, 1090 seconds mean, over more than 142,000 readings). This means the newest reading available to SMS is always some minutes behind the present moment — even on a perfectly healthy, running line.

SMS accounts for this rather than hiding it. Every screen that talks about "now" measures the lag from IFL's own data (the gap between when a reading was produced and when it was written) and judges whether the line is running against now — that lag, not the wall clock. The strip under the top bar states the lag in words, with a **details** link through to **Health**. Do not read "no readings in the last few minutes" as "the line is stopped" — check the stated lag first.

1.3 Plant clock and computer clock

SMS deliberately keeps two clocks separate, and never mixes them:

- **The plant's production clock.** Every cone, sack and reject reading carries a production timestamp written by the plant's own systems. This timestamp is stored labelled as UTC but is really the plant's own local wall clock.
- **The app's own clock.** Anything SMS itself writes — the product timeline, calibration adjustments, sync-run records, account actions — is stamped in genuine UTC, from the server the API and sync worker run on.

On this plant the two are about five hours apart (PLANT_UTC_OFFSET_MINUTES, UTC+5). A screen that shows both a production time and an app-written time never mixes them without saying so; when comparing the two matters, the screen states which clock it means.

1.4 Source generations, in plain words

IFL's own source tables can be rebuilt: dropped and recreated with every identity counter restarted from 1. This has already happened once, on 2026-08-05. SMS calls each such rebuilt period of a table a **generation** (or epoch). Two generations of the same table are not one continuous record — an id of 500 in one generation is a different row from id 500 in another — so SMS never silently merges them.

When the sync worker meets a generation it has not seen before, it halts and waits for an operator to run `epoch:accept` (see section 4.11 and Appendix B) rather than guessing. Reports and charts that would otherwise mix two generations state plainly that they cover one generation only, and how many readings from another generation were left out.

1.5 Glossary

Term	Meaning
Cone	A single wound package of yarn, weighed individually as it comes off a machine.
Sack	A finished sack of packed cones, weighed as a unit on the packing scale.
Station / machine	A physical spinning machine on the line; SMS uses "station" and "machine" for the same thing depending on the screen.
Reject	A cone the scale or an inspector marked as not acceptable — for a weight reason or a quality reason.
Product / material	The blend, count and tube combination a machine is currently running, recorded in PDAS.
PDAS	IFL's existing product-master database (PDAS_TP1U2) — blends, counts, tube types, materials and pallets. SMS reads it, and can optionally write to it (see section 6.4).
Generation	A distinct rebuild of one of IFL's source tables; see section 1.4.
Sync pass	One run of the sync worker's read-transform-write cycle.
DQ finding	A data-quality finding SMS raises about its own readings or its own connection health — shown on Health and Setup.
Shift day	The production day used for reporting, running 06:00 to 06:00 on the plant clock (see section 1.1 for how that clock is defined).

2 What is in the package

"The package" means the `sms` folder of the release, at one version (this guide describes version 0.2.0), plus what `npm ci` && `npm run build` produces on the server, plus this guide. Nothing else is needed from the developer's machine.

2.1 What you receive

Folder	What it is for
<code>shared</code>	Types and settings used by every other part.
<code>db</code>	The app database's setup: numbered migrations (001 to 042) and the bootstrap scripts that create the database and its logins.
<code>sync-worker</code>	The only program that talks to IFL's SQL Server. Read-only.
<code>cli</code>	The command-line tool, run as <code>node cli/dist/index.js <command></code> . See Appendix B.
<code>api</code>	The web service: sign-in, permissions and every screen's data. It also serves the web app once it is built.
<code>web</code>	The screens people see in the browser.
<code>scripts</code>	Backup, scheduled-task and database-maintenance scripts, and the plant simulator used only for demonstrations.
<code>layout-tests</code>	Browser-based layout tests. Used by developers; not needed to run SMS.

2.2 What is built on the server

`npm ci` && `npm run build` (see section 4.5) creates a `dist` folder inside `api`, `sync-worker`, `cli` and `web`. The two long-running programs are `api\dist\index.js` and `sync-worker\dist\index.js`.

2.3 What is not in the package

- **.env.** IT creates it from `.env.example` on the server (see section 4.4). It holds every password and is never shipped.
- **node_modules.** Restored by `npm ci`.
- **Log files.** Written at run time.
- **NSSM.** Third-party service software that IT must supply.
- **IFL's own data.** SMS reads it from IFL's SQL Server; it is never part of the package.

Note: Use the placeholders `C:\sms` for the install folder, `C:\sms-backups` for backups and `C:\sms\logs` for logs unless IT chose other folders.

3 What IFL IT must provide

Before installation begins (Chapter 4), IFL's IT department needs to have the following ready. Each item is referenced again from the installation steps that need it.

- **Server hardware.** A PC or server on the plant network with enough disk space for SQL Server Express and the app database, running Windows, set to the plant's own local time zone (UTC+5, the same offset the app itself is told about via `PLANT_UTC_OFFSET_MINUTES` — see section 6.1).
- **SQL Server Express.** Free, and already used elsewhere at the plant. It caps a single database file at 10 GB — see Appendix C, item 10, for what this means in practice.
- **Node.js**, the version pinned in the package's `.nvmrc` file. The API, sync worker and CLI all run on Node; `npm ci && npm run build` (section 4.5) needs it.
- **Microsoft Edge**, for PDF report export. The API launches Edge headless to render a report to PDF; `PDF_EDGE_PATH` can point at a non-default install location (see section 6.1).
- **NSSM** (the Non-Sucking Service Manager), to run the API and sync worker as Windows services that restart on crash and start with the machine. NSSM is third-party software and is not part of the SMS package — IT must download and provide it themselves.
- **Network access:** a static IP or a resolvable name for the server, and the API's port (`API_PORT`, 4000 by default) open in the Windows Firewall for anyone who will browse to SMS.
- **A read-only SQL login into IFL's own databases**, with `db_datareader` on both `DATA_TP1U2` and `PDAS_TP1U2`, and nothing more — SMS never writes to `DATA_TP1U2`, and writes to `PDAS_TP1U2` only through the separate, off-by-default path described in section 6.4. See section 4.2.
- **A Windows account** to run the scheduled backup, maintenance and retention tasks (RunAs in section 4.12) — it needs `db_backupoperator` on the app database.
- **A backup folder** the SQL Server service account can write to and the API can read from, for example `C:\sms-backups` — **Health** reports the age of the newest backup file it finds there.
- **A wall-display PC** (optional), if IFL wants a fullscreen, no-navigation board — any PC with a browser pointed at `/?s=wall` will do; see section 4.13.
- **A decision on who will be the first administrator**, so their account can be created in section 4.7 and they can create manager and engineer accounts for everyone else from **Setup**.

4 Installation, step by step

Run every command below from the package root (C:\sms once installed, or the extracted package folder) unless a step says otherwise. Each step names what you should see, and where to look if it does not match.

4.1 Prerequisites

1. Confirm every item in section 3 is in place: SQL Server Express reachable, Node.js installed at the version in .nvmrc, Microsoft Edge installed, NSSM downloaded, and the backup folder created.
2. Copy the package to its install folder, for example C:\sms.

You should see: the package folder containing api, web, cli, sync-worker, shared, db, and scripts subfolders, and no node_modules or .env (these are created by later steps). If it fails, see section 8.

4.2 Ask IFL's DBA for the read-only login

Before SMS can read anything, IFL's own database administrator must create a SQL login for SMS with db_datareader on DATA_TP1U2 and on PDAS_TP1U2, and nothing more. A template script for this is in the package at db\bootstrap\10_ifl_readonly_login.template.sql — hand it to IFL's DBA to adapt and run against their own server; SMS's own installer never connects to IFL's server to create this login itself (Working rule: never modify IFL's database without their own hand on it).

You should see: a login (the documented generic name is sms_readonly) with db_datareader on both databases, and its username/password recorded securely for step section 4.4. If it fails, see section 8.

4.3 Create the app database and its logins

1. Run the bootstrap script against the app database server, substituting the real server/instance name and two strong passwords:

```
sqlcmd -S <server\instance> -E -i db\bootstrap\00_create_app_database.sql -v AppPassword="..."
-v MigratePassword="..."
```

You should see: no error from sqlcmd, and the app database plus its sms_app and sms_migrate logins created on the server. If it fails, see section 8.

Note: -E uses your own Windows login to connect and create the database; it must be a login with permission to create databases and logins on that SQL Server instance.

4.4 Create .env

1. Copy .env.example (in the package root) to .env in the same folder.
2. Fill in every key described in section 6.1 — at minimum the APP_DB_* keys (using the sms_app login from the previous step), the IFL_DB_* keys (using the read-only login from section 4.2), LINE_ID, BACKUP_DIR, and PLANT_UTC_OFFSET_MINUTES.

You should see: a .env file with no __set_me__ placeholders left in it. If it fails, see section 8.

Warning: Never commit .env to version control and never send it by email. It holds every database password SMS uses.

4.5 npm ci and npm run build

1. From the package root, install dependencies and build every workspace:

```
npm ci && npm run build
```

You should see: `api\dist`, `sync-worker\dist`, `cli\dist` and `web\dist` each created with no build errors. On a plant PC with no internet access, run `npm ci` once on a machine that does have access and copy the resulting `node_modules` folders across instead — `npm ci` itself needs the npm registry. If it fails, see section 8.

Note: `npm run verify:release` (`npm run typecheck && npm test && npm run build`) is a stronger check than a plain build, if you want to confirm the package itself is sound before relying on it.

4.6 Migrate

1. Apply every database migration:

```
npm run db:migrate
```

You should see: each migration file applied in order with no error, ending at the newest migration in `db\migrations`. If it fails, see section 8.

Note: `MIGRATE_DB_USER/MIGRATE_DB_PASSWORD` (the `sms_migrate` login), if set, is preferred over `APP_DB_USER` for this one step only — set it in the shell you run this command from, not in `.env`, since it is never loaded by the long-running services.

4.7 First admin account

1. Create the first administrator account:

```
node cli/dist/index.js user:create --username=admin --password=<strong> --role=admin
```

You should see:

```
created user 'admin' (admin)
```

If it fails, see section 8.

Warning: The password must be at least 10 characters (`PASSWORD_MIN_LENGTH`). Choose the real administrator's username, not literally `admin`, if IFL prefers a personal account.

4.8 Manager accounts

1. Create one account per manager or engineer who needs to record changes (set the running product, log a calibration adjustment, record a sack movement, change local product limits — see section 6.3 for what each rank can do):

```
node cli/dist/index.js user:create --username=<u> --password=<p> --role=<viewer|engineer|manager|admin> [--display=<name>]
```

You should see: created user '`<u>`' (`<role>`) for each account created. If a role name is rejected, only viewer, engineer, manager and admin are valid — the older names operator and supervisor are refused. If it fails, see section 8.

Note: Every account can read every screen — Setup is the only screen restricted, to admin. Roles only govern who can write — see section 6.3.

4.9 Windows services (NSSM)

The API (`api\dist\index.js`) and the sync worker (`sync-worker\dist\index.js`) are meant to run continuously and restart automatically if they crash or the machine reboots. NSSM is the recommended way to do this on Windows, wrapping each as a Windows service (the documented generic service names are SMS-Api and SMS-Sync). NSSM is third-party software, outside the SMS package — follow NSSM's own instructions to register each service, pointing it at the Node executable and the built entry point for each process, with the working directory set to the package root so `.env` is found.

You should see: SMS-Api and SMS-Sync listed as running services in Windows' Services console, and `GET /api/health` answering once SMS-Api is running. If it fails, see section 8.

4.10 Firewall

1. Open the API's port for anyone on the plant network who needs to browse to SMS:

```
netsh advfirewall firewall add rule name="SMS API" dir=in action=allow protocol=TCP
localport=4000
```

You should see: the rule listed in Windows Firewall's inbound rules, and the SMS sign-in page reachable from another PC on the network at `http://<server>:4000/`. If it fails, see section 8.

4.11 First connection to the plant: sync halts → epoch:accept → verify

A brand-new app database has no source generation registered yet, so the very first sync is expected to stop and ask for one to be accepted — this is not a failure.

1. Run the first sync:

```
node cli/dist/index.js sync
```

You should see: it **halts**, reporting an unregistered source generation and exiting 1. This is expected on a first run.

2. Accept the generation currently on the plant. First without `--confirm`, to see the plan:

```
node cli/dist/index.js epoch:accept --all --provenance=ifl_live --label="Plant, live"
```

You should see: a printed plan describing the generation to register, and nothing changed yet.

3. Re-run identically with `--confirm` added to apply it:

```
node cli/dist/index.js epoch:accept --all --provenance=ifl_live --label="Plant, live" --
confirm
```

You should see: the generation registered, with no error.

4. Run sync again, and confirm the data against the source:

```
node cli/dist/index.js sync
node cli/dist/index.js verify
```

You should see: sync completes with per-table read/written counts and exit 0; verify reports no STOP lines and no weight mismatch.

5. List the registered generations at any time with:

```
node cli/dist/index.js epoch:list
```

If any of these steps fails, see section 8.

Warning: Use `--provenance=ifl_live` for the real plant connection. `--provenance=simulator` is refused unless the target database name ends in `_SIM`, and exists only for development and demonstration systems like the one that produced this guide's own screenshots.

4.12 Scheduled tasks

1. Register the three production scheduled tasks (nightly backup, weekly database maintenance, daily retention), previewing first with `-WhatIf`:

```
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File scripts\install-scheduled-tasks.ps1 -InstallDir
"C:\sms" -RunAs "<domain>\<svc account>" -BackupDir "C:\sms-backups" -WhatIf
```

2. Once the preview looks right, re-run the same command with `-WhatIf` removed to register the tasks for real.

Note: The script's own default for the app database is `localhost,14330` (the `-Server` parameter) and `sms` (`-Database`). If the app database on this server listens elsewhere, add `-Server "<host>,<port>"` to the command, or the nightly backup will look at the wrong place. Run the command as an administrator.

You should see: "SMS Nightly Backup", "SMS Weekly Maintenance" and "SMS Daily Retention" listed in Windows Task Scheduler. Confirm one runs with:

```
schtasks /run /tn "SMS Nightly Backup"
schtasks /query /tn "SMS Nightly Backup" /v /fo LIST
```

If it fails, see section 8 and Chapter 9's backup section.

4.13 Wall display PC

The wall display is any PC with a browser, pointed at `/?s=wall` on the SMS server — this view has no navigation and refreshes itself every 10 seconds, so it is meant to be left open, not signed out of. A dedicated Windows PC running Edge in kiosk mode is one way to do this:

```
msedge --kiosk http://<plant-ip>:4000/?s=wall --edge-kiosk-type=fullscreen
```

Create a low-privilege viewer account for the wall PC to sign in with, so its session can be revoked independently of any person's own account:

```
node cli/dist/index.js user:create --username=wall --password=<strong> --role=viewer
```

You should see: the wall board filling the screen with no browser chrome, updating on its own. If it fails, see section 8.

5 Verification checklist

Work through this list after installation (Chapter 4) and after any significant change — a service restart, a Windows update, a new source generation accepted. Tick each item off only once you have actually seen it, not because the step before it passed.

☐ GET /api/health returns "status": "ok", or a "degraded" status with a stated reason you recognise from section 8.

☐ **Health** shows **Everything is healthy.** as its headline — see the figure below.

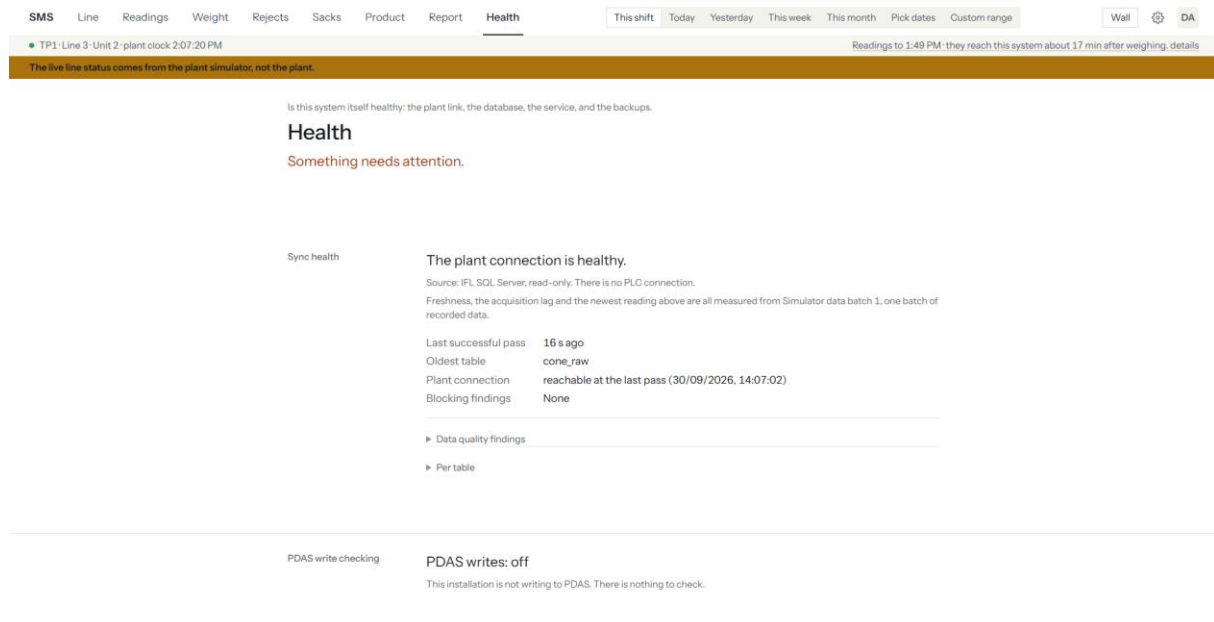


Figure 2 — Health on the demonstration copy: the Sync health block is healthy, but the headline reads "Something needs attention" because the demo has no backup. A clean installation should not show that. The blocks further down the screen are not in this picture.

☐ The sync block on **Health** shows a healthy outcome for every source table, not **The last sync attempt failed.** or **The plant connection has not delivered anything recently.**

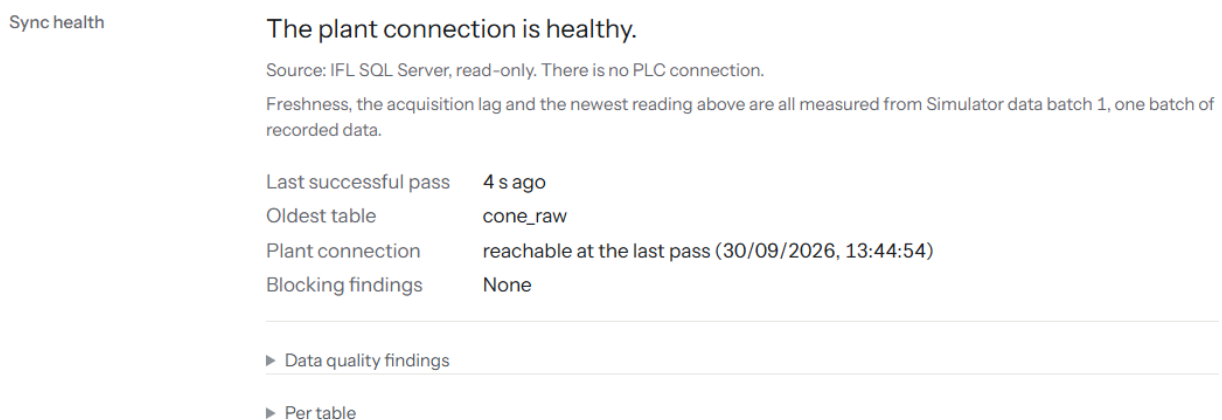


Figure 3 — The Sync health block: "The plant connection is healthy", the last successful pass, the oldest table and blocking findings, with Data quality findings and Per table folded away.

☐ node cli/dist/index.js verify exits clean: no STOP line, no weight mismatch.

- ☐ `node cli/dist/index.js epoch:list` shows the generation you accepted in section 4.11, with row counts that are growing on a re-run a few minutes later.
- ☐ The Backups block on **Health** says the newest backup has been proven restorable (**This backup has been proven restorable — RESTORE VERIFYONLY passed and its size still matches.**), not **This backup has not been proven restorable. Do not rely on it until it verifies.**
- ☐ The **Disk space** block on **Health** shows plenty free on both the database volume and the backup volume (SMS warns below 2 GB).
- ☐ The Database block on **Health** shows a size comfortably under the 10 GB SQL Server Express cap (see Appendix C, item 10).
- ☐ The Backups block on **Health** shows a recent backup, once the first scheduled backup has run (see section 4.12 and Chapter 9).
- ☐ Signing in as the first admin account works, and **Setup** is reachable (admin only — every other screen should also be reachable by every account you created).
- ☐ The **Sign out** menu item ends the session and returns to the sign-in form.
- ☐ SMS-Api and SMS-Sync (or whatever names NSSM was given) both show as running services, and restart on their own if stopped (test this deliberately once, in a maintenance window).
- ☐ The firewall rule from section 4.10 allows a browser on another PC on the plant network to reach SMS.

If any box cannot be ticked, do not consider the installation complete — work through section 8 for that symptom before moving on.

6 Configuration

6.1 The .env keys that matter

The full list of every key SMS reads is in Appendix A. The keys below are the ones most likely to need attention after the first install, or to be gotten wrong.

Key	Why it matters
COOKIE_SECURE	Must be <code>true</code> once SMS is served over HTTPS (the normal plant setup); set to <code>false</code> only on a plain-HTTP link such as a demonstration system — leaving it <code>true</code> on a plain-HTTP link means nobody can sign in, because the browser will not send the session cookie back.
PLANT_UTC_OFFSET_MINUTES	The plant's declared UTC offset, in minutes (UTC+5 = 300). Used for the two-clocks cross-check described in section 1.3 — get this wrong and Health may report a clock mismatch that is not real.
LINE_ID	Which line this installation serves. Immutable once data has been ingested against it — decide it once, correctly, before the first sync.
BACKUP_DIR	Where Health 's Backups block looks for the newest <code>.bak</code> file — it must match the <code>-OutDir/-BackupDir</code> value the backup scripts and scheduled tasks actually use, or Health will report no backup found even though one exists.
WEB_DIST	Set this (to <code>./web/dist</code>) so the API also serves the built web app itself — the normal single-process production setup described throughout this guide.
PDAS_WRITE_ENABLED	Master switch for the PDAS write path — see section 6.4. Off by default, and should stay off until the conditions in that section are met.
PDAS_LIMIT_MAX_SETPOINT_CHANGE_PCT, PDAS_LIMIT_MAX_OFFSET_CHANGE_G	The size of a limits change (default 3 % and 20 g) above which an engineer must confirm and give a longer reason. These are the developer's defaults, not IFL's; see section 6.4.
LIVE_ALLOW_SIMULATOR	Development only; never set at IFL. It lets the live screens follow the plant simulator. The API ignores it unless the database name ends in <code>_SIM</code> and the server is local.
WEIGHT_BASIS, SHIFT_MODE	Not yet confirmed by IFL for this plant (see Appendix C, item 12) — leave at their defaults (<code>as_recorded</code> , <code>corrected</code>) unless IFL has given a written answer.

6.2 Setup page

Setup is reached from the gear icon at the right of the top bar and is open only to admin accounts. It is one long page, not a set of tabs — each block below is a section of that same page.

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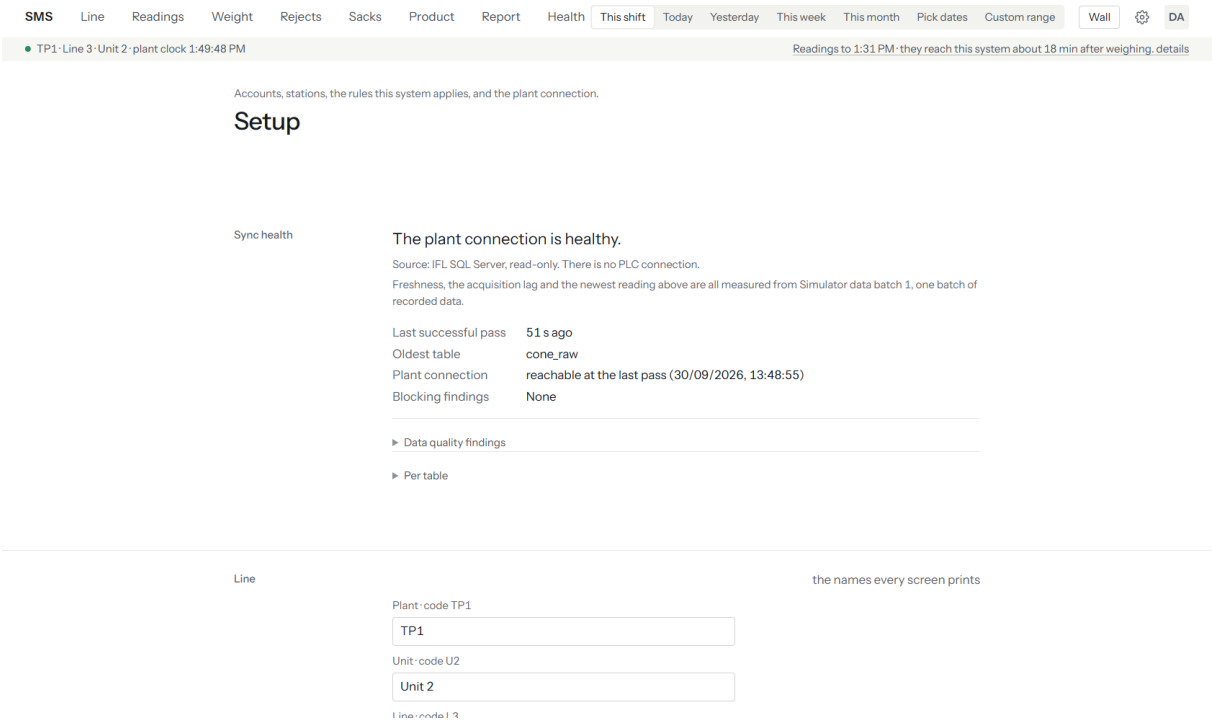


Figure 4 — The top of the Setup page: the heading, the Sync health block and the start of the Line block. The other blocks are shown separately below.

- **Sync health** — the same per-table sync outcome shown on **Health**, with more detail: the current watermark and the registered generation for each source table.

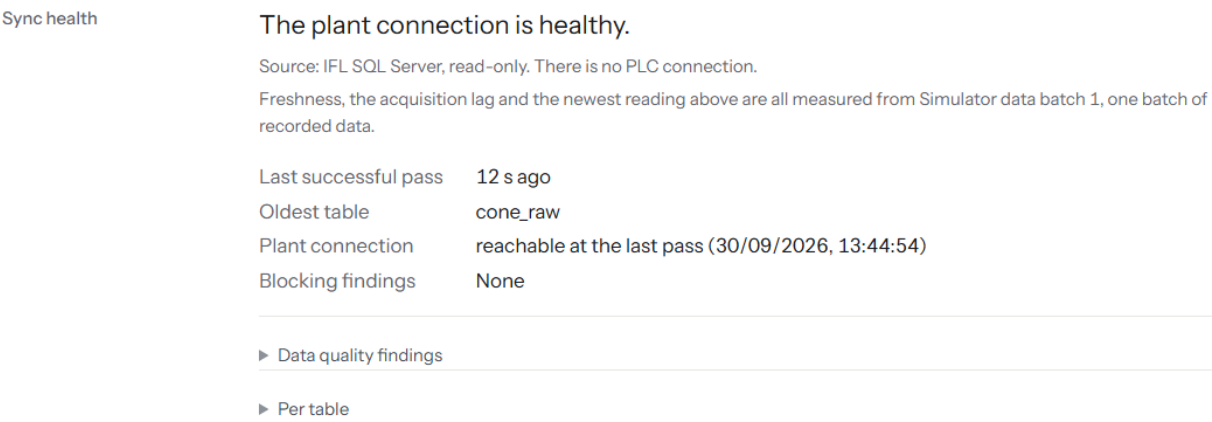


Figure 5 — Setup, Sync health block: healthy plant connection, last successful pass, oldest table, with Data quality findings and Per table folded away.

- **Line** — the line's own display name and identifying details.

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Line

the names every screen prints

Plant · code TP1

TP1

Unit · code U2

Unit 2

Line · code L3

Line 3

Display name

TP1 · Line 3 · Unit 2

Printed in the top bar, on the report, and as the subject of the headline
— "... is running" — so keep it short.

Save

This installation serves one line. IFL has not yet said whether a second line is wanted; the screens are built for one.

Figure 6 — Setup, Line block: plant, unit and line codes, the display name and Save.

- **Machines** — the roster of physical machines on the line. New ones are added with the **Add a machine** form (machine number, kind, name, make, model, notes).

Machines

the winders and the packer on this line

Stations are linked to the winder with the same number by default. IFL has not yet confirmed whether a machine and a station are the same thing.

No.	Kind	Make	Model	Name	Active	Linked station	
1	winder	Rieter	—	Winder 1	yes	1	Edit
2	winder	Rieter	—	Winder 2	yes	2	Edit
3	winder	Rieter	—	Winder 3	yes	3	Edit
4	winder	Rieter	—	Winder 4	yes	4	Edit
5	winder	Rieter	—	Winder 5	yes	5	Edit
6	winder	Rieter	—	Winder 6	yes	6	Edit
7	winder	Rieter	—	Winder 7	yes	7	Edit
8	winder	Rieter	—	Winder 8	yes	8	Edit
9	winder	Rieter	—	Winder 9	yes	9	Edit
10	winder	Rieter	—	Winder 10	yes	10	Edit
11	winder	Rieter	—	Winder 11	yes	11	Edit
12	winder	Rieter	—	Winder 12	yes	12	Edit
13	winder	Rieter	—	Winder 13	yes	13	Edit
14	winder	Rieter	—	Winder 14	yes	14	Edit
no number	packer	Neuenhauser	—	Sack packer No sack row carries a machine number, so this machine links to no station.	yes	none	Edit

Add a machine

Figure 7 — Setup, Machines block: 14 winders and the sack packer, each with Edit, and the Add a machine button.

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#	Winder	Never	—	Winder #	yes	#	Edit
8	winder	Rieter	—	Winder 8	yes	8	Edit
9	winder	Rieter	—	Winder 9	yes	9	Edit
10	winder	Rieter	—	Winder 10	yes	10	Edit
11	winder	Rieter	—	Winder 11	yes	11	Edit
12	winder	Rieter	—	Winder 12	yes	12	Edit
13	winder	Rieter	—	Winder 13	yes	13	Edit
14	winder	Rieter	—	Winder 14	yes	14	Edit
no number	packer	Neuenhauser	—	Sack packer No sack row carries a machine number, so this machine links to no station.	yes	none	Edit

Machine number (optional)

The number the plant writes on each reading. Leave it blank for a machine the readings never name, such as the packer.

Kind

Name

Make

Model

Notes

Figure 8 — The Add a machine form open: machine number, kind, name, make, model and notes, with Add and Cancel at the foot (the image is cropped at the bottom edge).

- **Stations** — the roster of weighing stations, each optionally linked to a machine. New ones are added with the **Add a station** form (station number, optional name).

Stations

the names every screen uses

#	Name	Machine	Active	
1	not named	Winder 1 ▾	yes	Rename
2	not named	Winder 2 ▾	yes	Rename
3	not named	Winder 3 ▾	yes	Rename
4	not named	Winder 4 ▾	yes	Rename
5	not named	Winder 5 ▾	yes	Rename
6	not named	Winder 6 ▾	yes	Rename
7	not named	Winder 7 ▾	yes	Rename
8	not named	Winder 8 ▾	yes	Rename
9	not named	Winder 9 ▾	yes	Rename
10	not named	Winder 10 ▾	yes	Rename
11	not named	Winder 11 ▾	yes	Rename
12	not named	Winder 12 ▾	yes	Rename
13	not named	Winder 13 ▾	yes	Rename
14	not named	Winder 14 ▾	yes	Rename

Add a station

Figure 9 — Setup, Stations block: 14 stations, none named yet, each linked to its winder, with Rename and Add a station.

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	not named	Winder 6	▼	yes	Rename
6	not named	Winder 6	▼	yes	Rename
7	not named	Winder 7	▼	yes	Rename
8	not named	Winder 8	▼	yes	Rename
9	not named	Winder 9	▼	yes	Rename
10	not named	Winder 10	▼	yes	Rename
11	not named	Winder 11	▼	yes	Rename
12	not named	Winder 12	▼	yes	Rename
13	not named	Winder 13	▼	yes	Rename
14	not named	Winder 14	▼	yes	Rename

Station number

Name (optional)

Machine

no machine ▼

Add

Cancel

Sources

where the readings come from

Server, database and login stay in the .env file on the plant PC. This lists what each connection is for, and which tables this line reads.

Source	Role	Connection	Enabled	Notes
--------	------	------------	---------	-------

Figure 10 — The Add a station form open: station number, optional name, machine, Add and Cancel.

- **Sources** — which source tables and generations feed this line.

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Sources

where the readings come from

Server, database and login stay in the .env file on the plant PC. This lists what each connection is for, and which tables this line reads.

Source	Role	Connection	Enabled	Notes
IFL weighing acquisition (DAT, ifl_sql)	weighing acquisition	IFL_DB	yes	
IFL product master (PDAS_TP, ifl_sql)	product master	PDAS	yes	
Sack packing database (not yet ifl_sql)	sack packing	IFL_DB	no	Sack rows are read from sac A separate sack-packing database has not been identified by IFL; sack readings come from the acquisition database.

A source that is disabled is not read by the sync worker: none of its tables are read on any pass until it is enabled again. Readings already copied stay as they are.

Tables this line reads

Kind	Table in the source database	Copied into	Enabled
cones	pack1_TP1U2	sms_raw.cone_raw	yes
sacks	sack1_TP1U2	sms_raw.sack_raw	yes
quality rejects	rejectQCS1_TP1U2	sms_raw.reject_qcs_raw	yes
weight rejects	rejectWeight1_TP1U2	sms_raw.reject_weight_raw	yes

Figure 11 — Setup, Sources block: the acquisition and product-master sources enabled, the sack-packing source disabled, and the four tables this line reads.

- **Rules** — the shift, weight and plausibility rules in force, and when they changed.

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Rules

what this system applies when it reads the plant's numbers

Weight

Weight basis

gross

Cone tube weight (g)

70

Sack tare (kg)

0.5

Why (optional)

Save

Shifts

Morning starts

06:00 AM

Evening starts

02:00 PM

Night starts

10:00 PM

A night shift belongs to

the day it starts

Shift attribution

corrected — from the weighing time

Recorded for when IFL says whether the plant's own shift column should be corrected or reproduced. It does not change anything yet.

Over the last 7 days the plant's stored shift differs from the derived shift on 1,664 of 47,467 readings (3.5%). That is what the mode above would change.

Why (optional)

Save

Plausible readings

Readings outside these bounds are treated as scale faults and left out of every average.

Lightest plausible cone (g)

1500

Heaviest plausible cone (g)

2100

Lightest plausible sack (kg)

40

Heaviest plausible sack (kg)

60

Why (optional)

Save

Product limits

The versioned history this system judges every reading by — each reading by the limits in force at its own time. Changing a limit here records a NEW version; it never rewrites or removes an old one, and readings already recorded keep the limits that were in force when they were weighed.

DEMO-20

Change limits

Limits	In force from	Source	By	Reason
1.950 ± 25 g	Sat 29 Aug 11:02 AM	pdas_created	—	In force since this material was created in PDAS (dbo.Materials.Timestamp).

DEMO-21

Change limits

Limits	In force from	Source	By	Reason
1.950 ± 25 g	Sat 29 Aug 11:02 AM	pdas_created	—	In force since this material was created in PDAS (dbo.Materials.Timestamp).

DEMO-1021

Change limits

Limits	In force from	Source	By	Reason
1.950 ± 25 g	Sat 29 Aug 11:02 AM	pdas_created	—	In force since this material was created in PDAS (dbo.Materials.Timestamp).

DEMO-1022

Change limits

Limits	In force from	Source	By	Reason
1.950 ± 25 g	Sat 29 Aug 11:02 AM	pdas_created	—	In force since this material was created in PDAS (dbo.Materials.Timestamp).

DEMO-1023

Change limits

Limits	In force from	Source	By	Reason
1.950 ± 25 g	Sat 29 Aug 11:02 AM	pdas_created	—	In force since this material was created in PDAS (dbo.Materials.Timestamp).

DEMO-1024 · retired

Change limits

Limits	In force from	Source	By	Reason
1.950 ± 25 g	Sat 29 Aug 11:02 AM	pdas_created	—	In force since this material was created in PDAS (dbo.Materials.Timestamp).

No later than marks a version first seen at that instant, not known to have started then; the oldest one is a lower bound.

Figure 12 — Setup, Rules block: weight basis and tube weight, shift start times and attribution, plausible-reading bounds, then the product limits history.

- Reject codes — every reject code with its type, tube code and material code, a Name box (the name applies to every reading, past and future), and Pass? and Severity choices. A code can also be named from the Rejects screen itself.

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Reject codes

what each inspection code means

IFL has not supplied the meaning of the codes. A name given here applies to every reading, past and future.

Type	Tube code	Material code	Name	Pass?	Severity
quality	1	1	not yet named	not known ▼	none ▼
quality	1	2	not yet named	not known ▼	none ▼
quality	2	1	not yet named	not known ▼	none ▼
quality	2	2	not yet named	not known ▼	none ▼
quality	3	1	not yet named	not known ▼	none ▼
quality	9	1	not yet named	not known ▼	none ▼
quality	10	1	not yet named	not known ▼	none ▼
quality	10	2	not yet named	not known ▼	none ▼
weight	—	—	not yet named	not known ▼	none ▼

Figure 13 — Setup, Reject codes block: nine codes from the demo, all still "not yet named".

- **People** — accounts. New ones are created with the **New account** form (**Username**, **Display name (optional)**, **Password**, **Role**); an existing account's password can be **Reset** from the same block. See section 6.3 for what each role can do.

People

who can sign in, and what each may change

Name	Username	Role	Active	Password
Demo Admin	demo-admin · you	admin	yes	from the account menu
New account				

Figure 14 — Setup, People block: the one demo account, with a New account button.

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quality	9	1	not yet named	not known ▼	none ▼
quality	10	1	not yet named	not known ▼	none ▼
quality	10	2	not yet named	not known ▼	none ▼
weight	—	—	not yet named	not known ▼	none ▼

People

who can sign in, and what each may change

Name	Username	Role	Active	Password	
Demo Admin	demo-admin	you	admin	yes	from the account menu

Username

Display name (optional)

Password

Role

manager ▼

Save Cancel

Audit log

every change made through this application

Figure 15 — The New account form open and empty: username, display name, password, role and Save.

- **Audit log** — every write SMS itself has made: account changes, calibration adjustments, product changes, and PDAS write attempts.

Audit log

every change made through this application

When	Who	What	Detail
30/09/2026, 13:38:19	Demo Admin	auth.login	from ::ffff:127.0.0.1
30/09/2026, 13:36:52	Demo Admin	auth.login	from ::ffff:127.0.0.1
30/09/2026, 13:36:44	Demo Admin	auth.login	from ::ffff:127.0.0.1
30/09/2026, 13:36:35	Demo Admin	auth.login	from ::ffff:127.0.0.1
30/09/2026, 13:36:29	Demo Admin	auth.login	from ::ffff:127.0.0.1
30/09/2026, 13:33:47	no one signed in	user.create	role admin; by the CLI (sms user:create), no signed-in actor

Figure 16 — Setup, Audit log block: five sign-ins and one account created from the command line.

6.3 Roles and what each can do

Every screen described in Chapter 7 is open to every signed-in account, at every rank — **Setup** is the only screen restricted, to **admin**. Roles govern writing, not reading:

Role	Rank	Can additionally do
viewer	1	Read every screen. Cannot write anything.
engineer	2	Set the running product, log a calibration adjustment, name a reject code, record a sack movement, set local product limits, acknowledge a known data finding on Health .
manager	3	Everything engineer can, plus export a report or the raw register.
admin	4	Everything manager can, plus everything in Setup : accounts, machines, stations, rules.

Note: PDAS writes (creating or retiring a product, changing limits in PDAS, executing a changeover) require rank 2 (engineer) and PDAS_WRITE_ENABLED=true — see section 6.4. Rank alone does not turn this on.

6.4 PDAS writes: what they are, why they are off, what enabling them requires

SMS can, in principle, write to IFL's product-master database (PDAS_TP1U2) through the same stored procedures IFL's own PDAS client uses — creating or retiring a material, adding a blend/count/tube type, creating or retiring a pallet, and changing a material's weight limits. This is a **separate path** from the read-only connection used for everything else in this guide: it uses its own login (PDAS_WRITE_USER, the documented generic name is sms_pdas_writer), never the read-only login.

Why it is off. PDAS_WRITE_ENABLED=false is the default, and stays false until all of the following are true:

- IFL has given written authority for SMS to write to PDAS.
- A separate sms_pdas_writer login has been provisioned on the plant's own PDAS server (PDAS_WRITE_SERVER/PORT/DATABASE/USER/PASSWORD in Appendix A) — distinct from the read-only login.
- The write path has been proven end to end against a non-production copy first.

What a limits change asks for. Changing a product's limits is a two-step form: a review step that shows each old and new value with the change in grams and per cent, then a write step. A change that moves the target by more than 3 % or a limit by more than 20 g is called out as a large change and needs a tick in the box and a reason of at least 20 characters. Those two figures are the developer's own choice, not IFL's, and can be changed in .env. On Product > Catalogue the block **Pallets in PDAS** lists every pallet with a Retire or Reactivate button, gated the same way as products. Who at IFL may make these changes, and how a changed limit reaches the machine, are still open questions; SMS does not claim to know.

What it looks like while off. Product > Changeover's **Check the plan** button still works — it is a read-only dry run that never opens the PDAS writer connection. Its **Execute the changeover** button is disabled, and the screen states why, in the server's own words: **PDAS_WRITE_ENABLED is not true.** Health's PDAS write block reads **PDAS writes: off** with the body text **This installation is not writing to PDAS. There is nothing to check.**

What enabling it requires. Set PDAS_WRITE_ENABLED=true and fill in the PDAS_WRITE_* connection keys in .env, once every condition above is met. Every write made through this path is checked: read back from PDAS immediately afterward, with any mismatch raised as a finding rather than assumed to have succeeded. A changeover executed this way still only makes a product selectable in PDAS — it does not, by itself, put that product on a machine; whether the machine's own controller reads its limits from PDAS live is a separate question for IFL.

6.5 Optional TLS

SMS can terminate TLS itself rather than sit behind IIS or another reverse proxy, using TLS_CERT_PATH/TLS_KEY_PATH (a certificate and key file pair) or TLS_PFX_PATH/TLS_PFX_PASSPHRASE (a combined PFX file). Leave all four unset to serve plain HTTP — reasonable on an isolated plant LAN, but then COOKIE_SECURE must be false (see section 6.1) or nobody will be able to stay signed in.

7 Daily use

This chapter walks through every screen a signed-in person uses. Each section says what the screen is for, shows it, lists the steps for the usual jobs, and explains what each part of the screen means.

Note: Every screenshot in this chapter was taken from a demonstration copy of SMS fed by the plant simulator, not by IFL's plant. The numbers, product names (DEMO-20, DEMO-21 and so on) and the single "Demo Admin" account are therefore made up. A yellow banner across the top of the screen says so whenever the figures come from the simulator; at IFL that banner does not appear. Your own screens will show your own numbers, but the layout and wording are the same.

Every screen is open to every signed-in account; only **Setup** is limited to administrators (see section 6.3). What differs by role is who may change things: recording the running product, logging a calibration adjustment or naming a reject code needs the engineer role or above, and exporting a report needs manager or above.

7.1 Signing in, the top bar and the period

Open the SMS address in a browser. The first thing you see is the sign-in form.

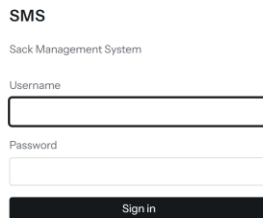
The image shows a web form for signing into the SMS (Sack Management System). At the top, it says "SMS" in bold, followed by "Sack Management System" in a smaller font. Below this, there are two input fields: "Username" and "Password". The "Username" field is a simple text box. The "Password" field is a text box with a small eye icon to its right, indicating a toggle for password visibility. Below these fields is a dark button with the text "Sign in" in white.

Figure 17 — Sign-in form: SMS, Sack Management System, Username and Password fields, Sign in button.

1. Type your username in **Username**.
2. Type your password in **Password**.
3. Press **Sign in**.

If the details are wrong SMS says **That username and password did not match.** and after several wrong attempts it makes you wait a few minutes before trying again. It never says which of the two was wrong.

Once you are in, every screen shares the same bar along the top.

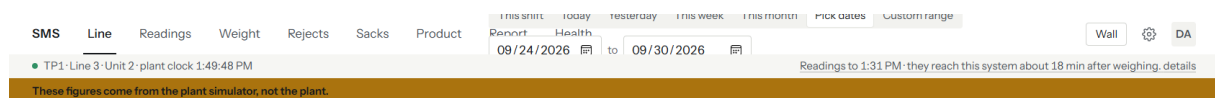
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Figure 18 — The top bar and the strip beneath it: screen names, Health, the period buttons, the Wall button, the gear icon, the DA account menu, the plant clock and the data-age sentence.

Part	What it tells you
SMS and the screen names	Click a name to move to that screen: Line , Readings , Weight , Rejects , Sacks , Product , Report and Health . The current one is underlined.
Period buttons (This shift , Today , Yesterday , This week , This month , Pick dates , Custom range)	The stretch of time every screen is describing. It applies to the whole application at once: change it here and each screen follows.
Wall	Opens the fullscreen wall display (see section 7.9).
Gear icon	Opens Setup . Only administrators see it.
Initials button (here "DA")	Opens the account menu described below.
plant clock	The time at the plant, not the time on your PC. All SMS times use the plant's clock.
The sentence on the right, ending in details	How fresh the data is. Readings reach SMS about 18 minutes after the cone is weighed, so this sentence names the time of the newest reading and the delay. If it warns that nothing has arrived, the plant link may be down and no screen should be read as "the line is running".

To look at a stretch of time that is not a shift, day, week or month, press **Pick dates**. Two date boxes appear where the period buttons were.



Is the line running, what has it made this period, and does anything need attention?

Line 3 is running right now. Figures below cover 24 Sept to 30 Sept 2026.

47,391 cones
99.7% within the scale's limits

2,193 sacks
103,626 kg

1,362 rejected
2.8% of everything weighed

199
outside the product's limits
10 could not be judged

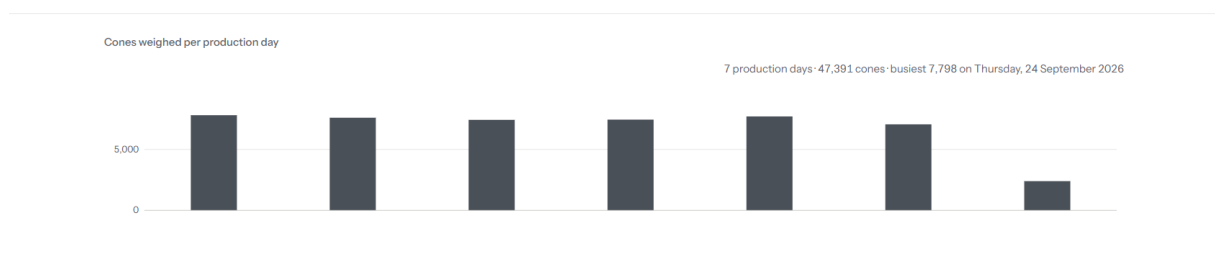


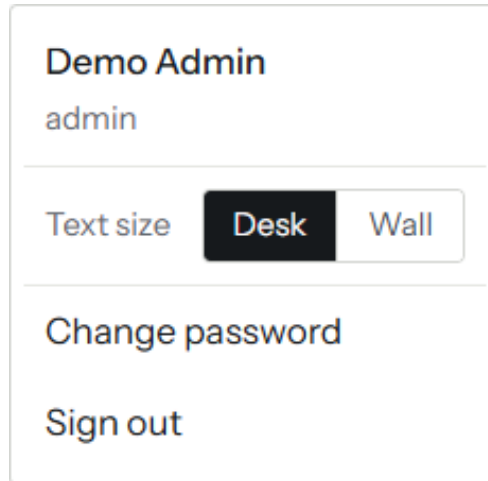
Figure 19 — Line screen with Pick dates chosen: the two date boxes (24 Sept to 30 Sept) appear over the top bar and cover part of the Report and Health tabs.

Note: In the current release the date boxes are drawn over the top bar and can hide the **Report** and

Health names while they are open, as the figure shows. Choose the dates, then press a screen name once the boxes have closed.

1. Press **Pick dates**.
2. Enter the first and last day in the boxes.
3. Read the screen; it now covers those days.

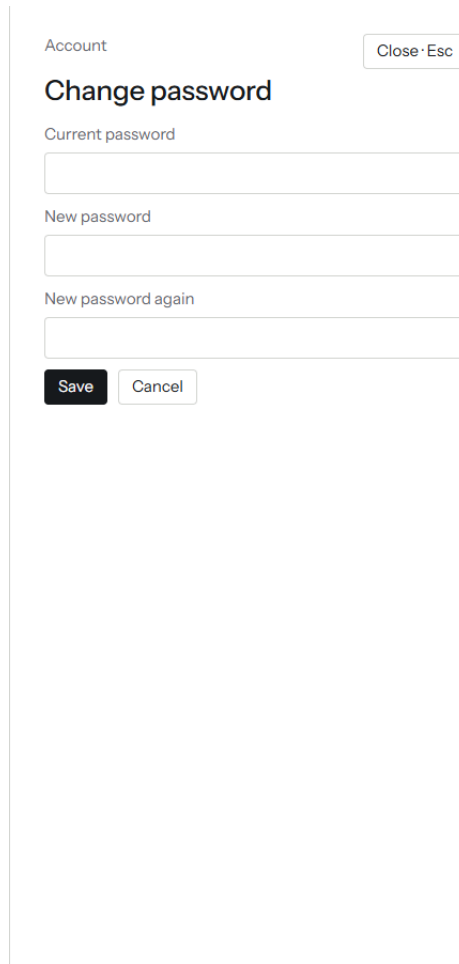
The initials button at the right of the bar opens the account menu.



The screenshot shows a user account menu. At the top, it displays the name 'Demo Admin' and the role 'admin'. Below this is a 'Text size' section with two buttons: 'Desk' (which is highlighted in black) and 'Wall'. At the bottom, there are two more options: 'Change password' and 'Sign out'.

Figure 20 — The account menu: name Demo Admin, role admin, Text size with Desk and Wall choices, Change password, Sign out.

- **Text size** switches between **Desk** (normal) and **Wall** (larger, for a screen read from a distance).
- **Change password** opens a small form.
- **Sign out** ends the session.



Account Close · Esc

Change password

Current password

New password

New password again

Save Cancel

Figure 21 — The Change password panel, empty: Current password, New password, New password again, Save and Cancel.

To change your own password:

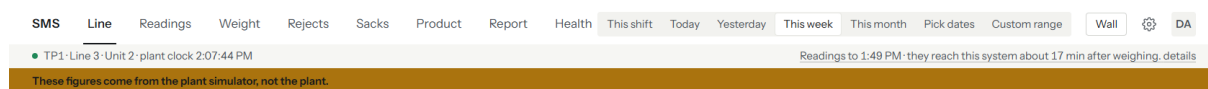
1. Open the account menu and choose **Change password**.
2. Type the current password, then the new one twice.
3. Press **Save**. Press **Cancel**, or the Esc key, to leave without saving.

An administrator can also reset another person's password from **Setup**; see section 6.3 and Chapter 10.

7.2 Line: is it running right now?

Line is the screen SMS opens on. It answers one question: is the line running, what has it made this period, and does anything need attention?

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1. Press **Line** in the top bar.
2. Choose a period. **This shift** shows the current shift so far.
3. Read the headline first. It says whether the line is running, stopped or idle, and how far into the shift it is.
4. Look at the Attention block. If it lists something, press **See them**.
5. To see which product each machine is making, read "What is being made".

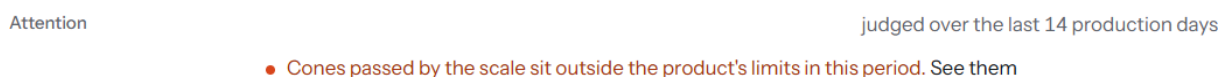


Figure 23 — The Attention block on the demo: one finding, cones passed by the scale that sit outside the product's limits, with a See them link.

Part	What it tells you
Headline ("Line 3 is running — 7 h 44 min into the morning shift...")	Whether the line is running, based on when the newest reading arrived, corrected for the 18-minute delay. When the data link is unhealthy the headline refuses to say.
The four big figures	Cones weighed and the share within the scale's limits; sacks and their weight; cones rejected; and cones the scale passed that sit outside the product's own limits.
Cones weighed per shift	A shape comparison between shifts. With only one shift in the period it says so, as in the figure; choose This week to see it.
Attention	Things that need a person to look: cones outside product limits, a station reading consistently heavy or light, a rising reject rate. It always looks back 14 production days, whatever period you chose.

Part	What it tells you
Stations bars	One bar per station: cones this period against the middle station. A station with many rejects shows its count underneath. The demo's station 7 has 38 rejected.
What is being made	The product each machine is running now, and for how long at least. It is anchored on the newest reading, not on your chosen period. The Change and History buttons open the Product screen.
Last readings	The most recent sack and cone. Click either to open its record.

7.3 Readings: every cone and every sack

Readings is the register. It lists each cone or sack that was weighed, newest first, so you can look up one reading or scan a stretch of them.

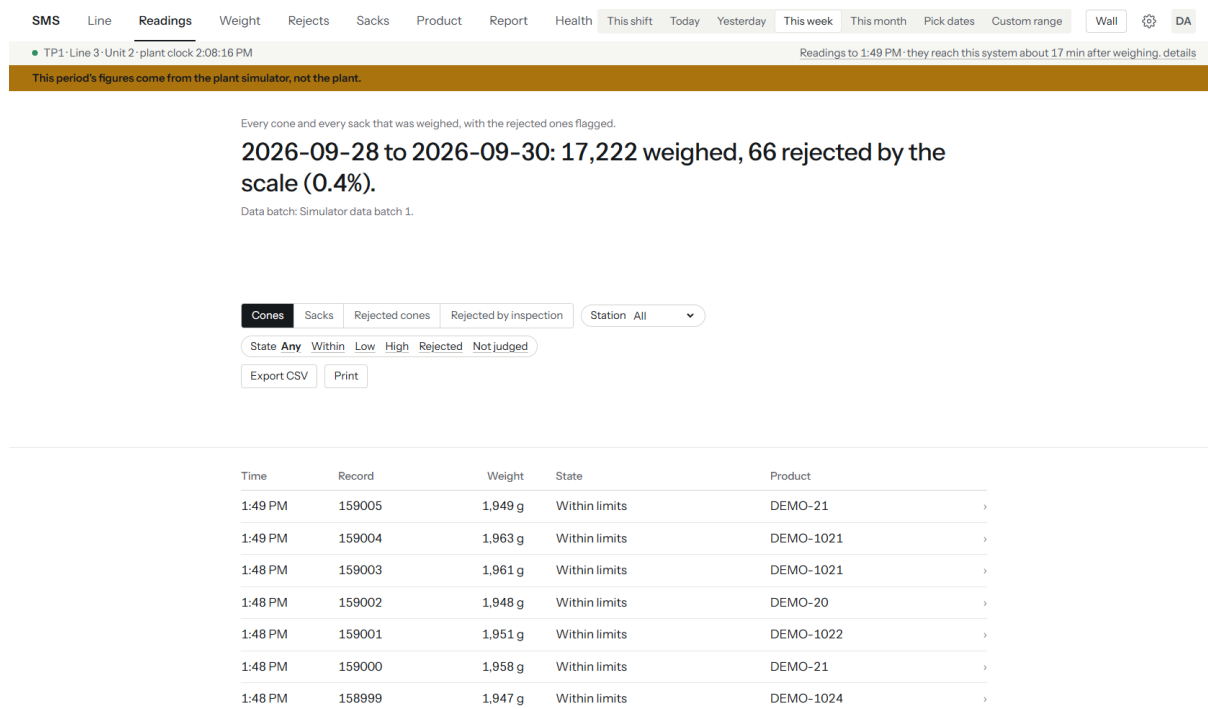


Figure 24 — Readings, Cones list for This week: the headline, the Cones, Sacks, Rejected cones and Rejected by inspection tabs, the Station and State filters, Export CSV and Print, and the first rows of the list with time, record, weight, state and product. The list continues below.

1. Press **Readings**.
2. Choose the list with the buttons under the headline: **Cones, Sacks, Rejected cones** or **Rejected by inspection**.
3. Narrow the cones list with the **Station** box and the State buttons.
4. Press any row to open its record.
5. Use Next and Previous at the foot of the list to page through it.

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SMS

Line

Readings

Weight

Rejects

Sacks

Product

Report

Health

This shift

Today

Yesterday

This week

This month

Pick dates

Custom range

Wall

⚙

DA

● TP1-Line 3-Unit 2-plant clock 1:44:20 PM

Readings to 1:26 PM: they reach this system about 18 min after weighing. details

This period's figures come from the plant simulator, not the plant.

Every cone and every sack that was weighed, with the rejected ones flagged.

Wednesday, 30 September 2026: 12 cones rejected by the scale.

Data batch: Simulator data batch 1.

Cones

Sacks

Rejected cones

Rejected by inspection

Station All

Export CSV

Print

Time	Record	Weight	State	Product
1:04 PM	158788	1,987 g	Rejected by the scale	DEMO-20
12:59 PM	158761	1,984 g	Rejected by the scale	DEMO-21
11:33 AM	158308	2,003 g	Rejected by the scale	DEMO-1023
10:56 AM	158118	1,995 g	Rejected by the scale	DEMO-1021
10:54 AM	158108	1,980 g	Rejected by the scale	DEMO-20
9:58 AM	157743	1,929 g	Rejected by the scale	DEMO-21
8:10 AM	157175	1,926 g	Rejected by the scale	DEMO-1021
7:25 AM	156959	1,907 g	Rejected by the scale	DEMO-20
6:47 AM	156723	1,923 g	Rejected by the scale	DEMO-21
6:19 AM	156620	2,001 g	Rejected by the scale	DEMO-20
6:17 AM	156603	1,941 g	Rejected by the scale	DEMO-1021
6:02 AM	156541	1,909 g	Rejected by the scale	DEMO-20

● new readings appear every 15 seconds

100 a page, newest first · 12 in this period

Figure 25 — Readings, Rejected cones list: 12 cones the scale rejected this shift, shaded, each with its time, record number, weight and product.

SMS

Line

Readings

Weight

Rejects

Sacks

Product

Report

Health

This shift

Today

Yesterday

This week

This month

Pick dates

Custom range

Wall

⚙

DA

● TP1-Line 3-Unit 2-plant clock 2:08:16 PM

Readings to 1:49 PM: they reach this system about 17 min after weighing. details

This period's figures come from the plant simulator, not the plant.

Every cone and every sack that was weighed, with the rejected ones flagged.

2026-09-28 to 2026-09-30: 826 sacks weighed.

Data batch: Simulator data batch 1.

Cones

Sacks

Rejected cones

Rejected by inspection

Export CSV

Print

Time	Sack	Weight	Status
1:49 PM	10887	47.37 kg	Passed
1:41 PM	10886	47.26 kg	Passed
1:36 PM	10885	47.19 kg	Passed
1:35 PM	713	47.41 kg	Passed
1:32 PM	711	47.22 kg	Passed
1:30 PM	712	47.24 kg	Passed
1:22 PM	709	47.23 kg	Passed
1:22 PM	710	47.25 kg	Passed
1:19 PM	708	47.31 kg	Passed
1:18 PM	707	47.18 kg	Passed

Figure 26 — Readings, Sacks list for This week: 826 sacks, the first rows with time, sack number, weight and Passed status, and Export CSV and Print.

Part	What it tells you
Headline	How many were weighed and how many the scale rejected in the period.

Part	What it tells you
Data batch line	Which batch of source data this period comes from. On the demo it reads "Simulator data batch 1".
State column	The scale's own verdict: Within limits, or Rejected by the scale. A second fact, "outside the product's limits", appears only where a product was recorded for that reading.
Export CSV	Downloads the list you are looking at as a spreadsheet file (manager or above).
Print	Prints the list with the line, period and time it was produced in the page header.
"new readings appear every 15 seconds"	The list refreshes itself while you look at it.

Press a cone, sack or rejected row to open its record.

Cone · Station 2 · Morning shift
Close · Esc

1,932 g

Within limits

Within the product's limits, 1,950 ± 25 g.

Weighed
Wednesday, 30 September 2026, 1:21 PM

Shift
Morning

Station
Station 2

Source record
301702

Product then
DEMO-21

See this product's report · opens the product report for this product, on this reading's day ·

See this product in the catalogue · opens Product › Catalogue for this product

▶ Where this reading came from

Figure 27 — Cone record: 1,932 g, Within limits, from station 2 on the morning shift, weighed at 1:21 PM, source record, product DEMO-21 at that time, with links to the product's report and catalogue.

Cone · Station 6 · Morning shift

Close · Esc

1,987 g

Rejected by the scale

Rejected by the scale; 12 g over the upper limit,
1,950 ± 25 g.

Weighed

Wednesday, 30 September
2026, 1:04 PM

Shift

Morning

Station

Station 6

Source record

301600

Product then

DEMO-20

See this product's report · opens the product report for
this product, on this reading's day ·

See this product in the catalogue · opens Product ›
Catalogue for this product

► Where this reading came from

Figure 28 — Cone record for a rejected cone: 1,987 g, "Rejected by the scale; 12 g over the upper limit", station 6.

Sack · Morning shift Close · Esc

47.19 kg

Passed

Recorded	Wednesday, 30 September 2026, 1:36 PM
Shift	Morning
Sack	10885
Source record	12736

The plant records no separate weighing time for a sack — this is when the reading was written, which can trail the actual weighing.

About 0 cones were weighed between the previous sack and this one (approximate; the plant records no link between a cone and its sack).

[► Where this reading came from](#)

Figure 29 — Sack record: 47.19 kg, Passed, sack number 10885, with the note that the plant records no link from a cone to its sack.

Press the **Close** button or the Esc key to go back to the list. Note that the sack record says the time is when the plant wrote the reading, which can trail the actual weighing, and that the "cones weighed between this sack and the previous one" figure is an estimate; SMS does not know which cones went into which sack.

7.4 Weight: are the cones the right weight?

Weight answers whether cones are at the right weight and whether any station's scale needs attention.

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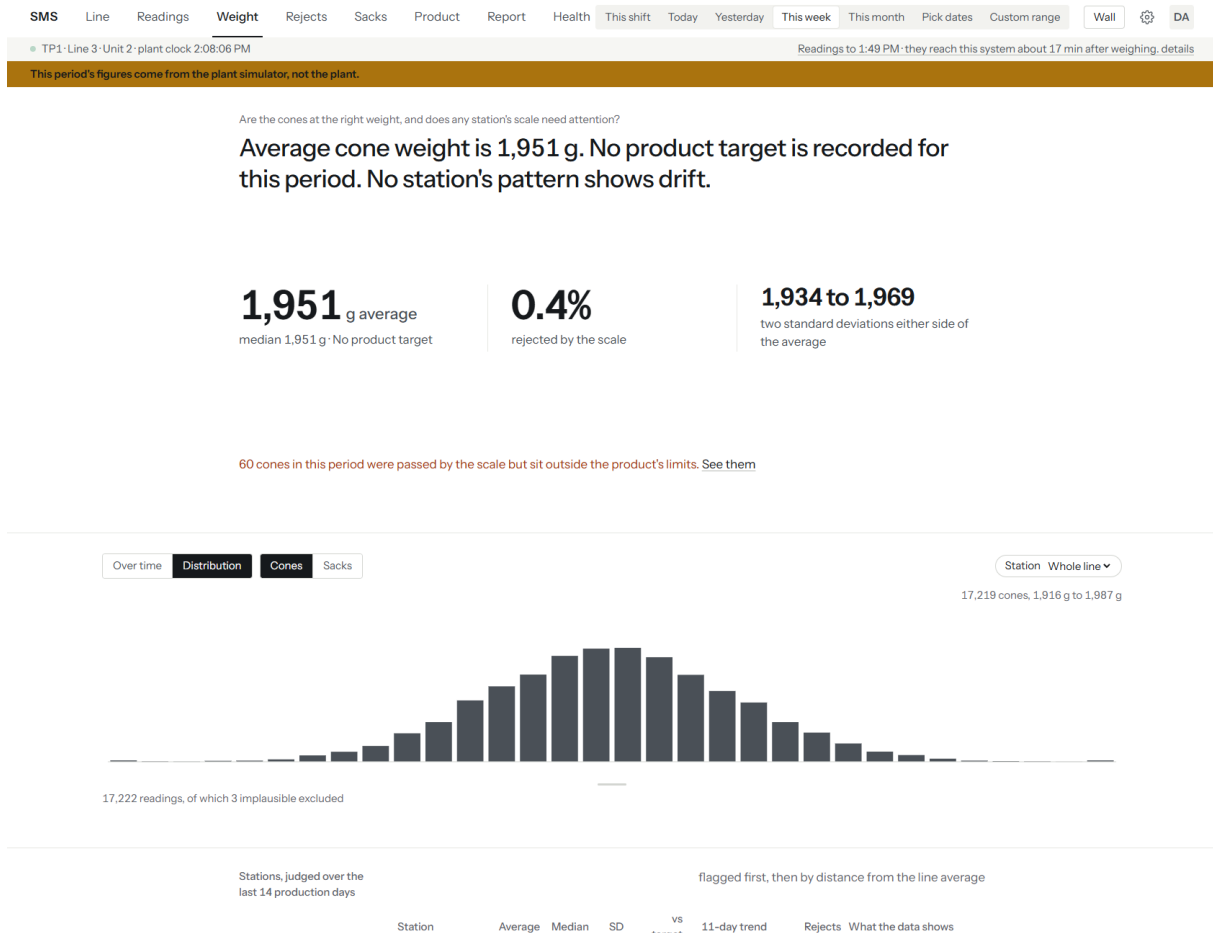


Figure 30 — Weight, This week, Distribution view: average cone weight 1,951 g, "No product target is recorded for this period", the two-standard-deviation range, and the bell-shaped spread of the cones. The station table lies below the visible part of the screen.

Note: The demo has no product target recorded for the line as a whole, so this screenshot has no target or limit lines on the chart and the headline says so. On a real installation with a running product recorded you will see them.

1. Press **Weight** and choose a period.
2. Read the headline: the average cone weight and, where a target exists, how it compares.
3. Use the buttons above the chart to switch between **Over time** and **Distribution**, and between **Cones** and **Sacks**.
4. Use the **Station** box to look at one station instead of the whole line.
5. Press a station's name in the table to open its record.

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Figure 31 — Weight, This week, Over time view: group means across 17,124 readings, with three unusually low groups marked in red.

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Stations, judged over the last 14 production days

flagged first, then by distance from the line average

Station	Average	Median	SD	vs target	11-day trend	Rejects	What the data shows
Station 10 ›	1,953 g	1,953 g	8.7 g	+3 g		2.0%	Steady.
Station 9 ›	1,952 g	1,952 g	8.8 g	+2 g		2.8%	Steady.
Station 6 ›	1,952 g	1,952 g	8.8 g	+2 g		2.7%	Steady.
Station 1 ›	1,952 g	1,951 g	8.7 g	+2 g		2.1%	Steady.
Station 8 ›	1,952 g	1,952 g	8.8 g	+2 g		1.6%	Steady.
Station 3 ›	1,952 g	1,952 g	8.7 g	+2 g		1.8%	Steady.
Station 4 ›	1,948 g	1,949 g	8.7 g	-2 g		2.7%	Steady.
Station 12 ›	1,951 g	1,951 g	8.8 g	+1 g		1.2%	Steady.
Station 14 ›	1,951 g	1,952 g	8.6 g	+1 g (retired in PDAC)		2.5%	Steady.
Station 7 ›	1,951 g	1,951 g	8.7 g	+1 g		23.4%	Steady.
Station 5 ›	1,951 g	1,951 g	8.7 g	+1 g		2.5%	Steady.
Station 2 ›	1,951 g	1,952 g	8.7 g	+1 g		2.2%	Steady.
Station 11 ›	1,951 g	1,951 g	8.7 g	+1 g		1.9%	Steady.
Station 13 ›	1,950 g	1,950 g	8.8 g	0 g		2.7%	Steady.

Trend column: one shared scale for every station, 1,946 g to 1,956 g.

Figure 32 — The station table on Weight, This week: each station's average, median, spread, difference from the target, 11-day trend, reject share and verdict. Station 4 sits about 2 g below the others and station 7 rejects 23.4%; every station is still marked Steady.

Part	What it tells you
Average, "rejected by the scale" and "two standard deviations either side"	The centre, the share the scale rejected, and the normal spread of cone weights.
Distribution chart	How many cones fell at each weight. A single bell is healthy; two bumps or a long tail suggest a problem.
Over time chart	The average weight of consecutive groups of cones. Red points are groups that fell outside the usual range.
Station table	One row per station. "vs target" shows how far the station's average is from the target in force. The trend column uses one shared scale so stations compare fairly. The last column says Steady unless a drift pattern has held for several days.
Judged over the last 14 production days	The table always looks back 14 days, whatever period you chose, because a drift needs consecutive days to show.

Press a station to see its detail.

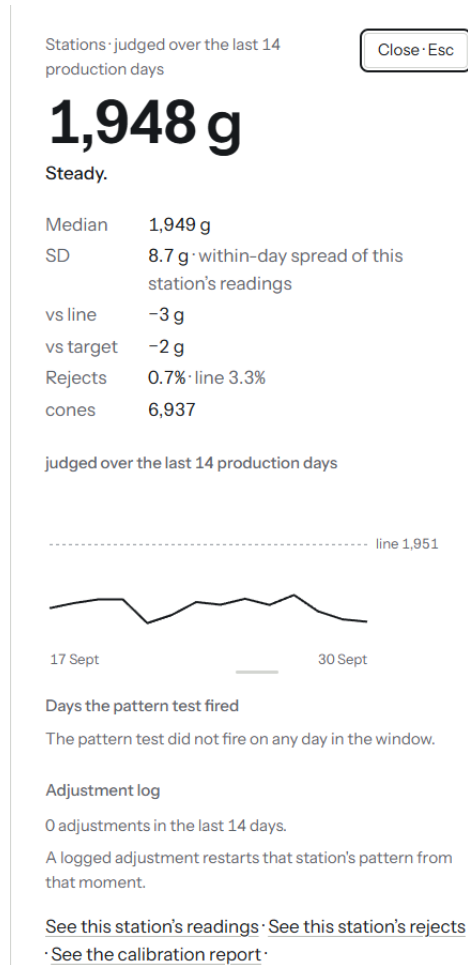


Figure 33 — Station 4's record: average 1,948 g, Steady, difference from the line and target, reject share, 14-day line and adjustment log.

An engineer or above can log that a scale was adjusted, so later readings are judged from that moment on. Scroll to the bottom of the station's record.

Adjustment log

0 adjustments in the last 14 days.

A logged adjustment restarts that station's pattern from that moment.

[See this station's readings](#) · [See this station's rejects](#)
 · [See the calibration report](#) ·
[See this machine by shift](#)

Adjusted at (plant time)

Plant time. Stored as an app instant and converted with the offset the server reports, never the browser's.

Amount (grams, signed)

Why — Station 4

Note

Reference weight (g)

Reference read before (g)

Reference read after (g)

Product in force

DEMO-21 — from the machine's newest cones [clear](#)

► Show the working

Figure 34 — The station record's adjustment form: when, the amount in grams, why, a note, reference weights, the product in force, Save and Cancel. Nothing was saved when this was captured.

1. Open the station from the table.
2. Fill in when it was adjusted (plant time), the amount in grams and the reason.
3. Press **Save**. An adjustment cannot be edited afterwards; a correction is a new entry.

The weighing data cannot tell a heavy scale from heavy cones, so SMS never says which way to adjust a station.

7.5 Rejects: why are cones being rejected?

Rejects answers how many cones are rejected, for what reason, whether it is getting worse, and where.

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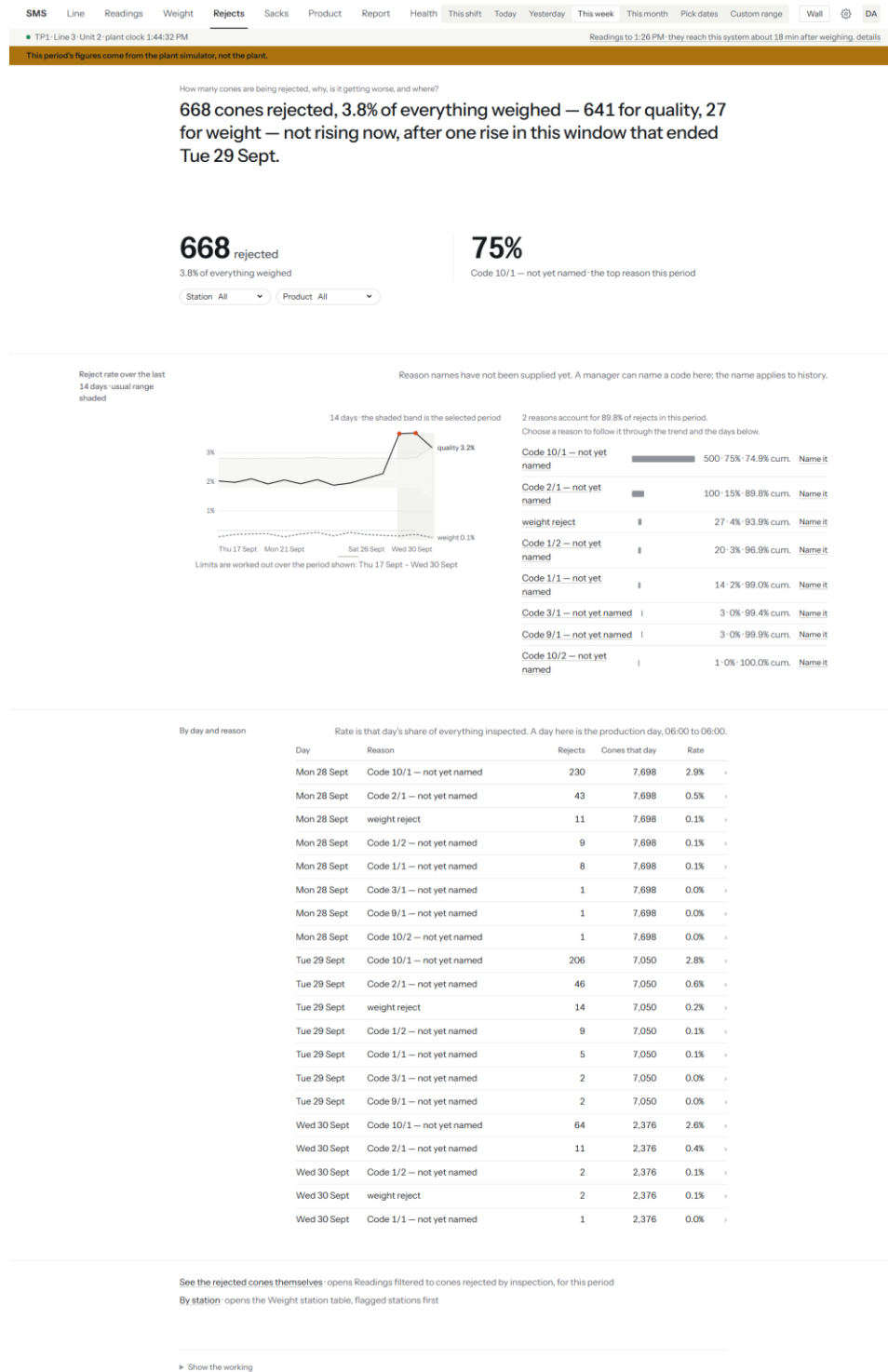


Figure 35 — Rejects, This week: 668 cones rejected (3.8%), Code 10/1 the top reason at 75%, the 14-day reject rate, the reasons chart with a Name it link on each, and the day-by-reason table.

1. Press **Rejects** and choose a period.
2. Use **Station** and **Product** boxes to narrow the picture.
3. Press a reason in the reasons list to follow it through the trend and days.
4. Press the same reason again, or the small x on its chip, to clear it.
5. To give a reason a name, see below.

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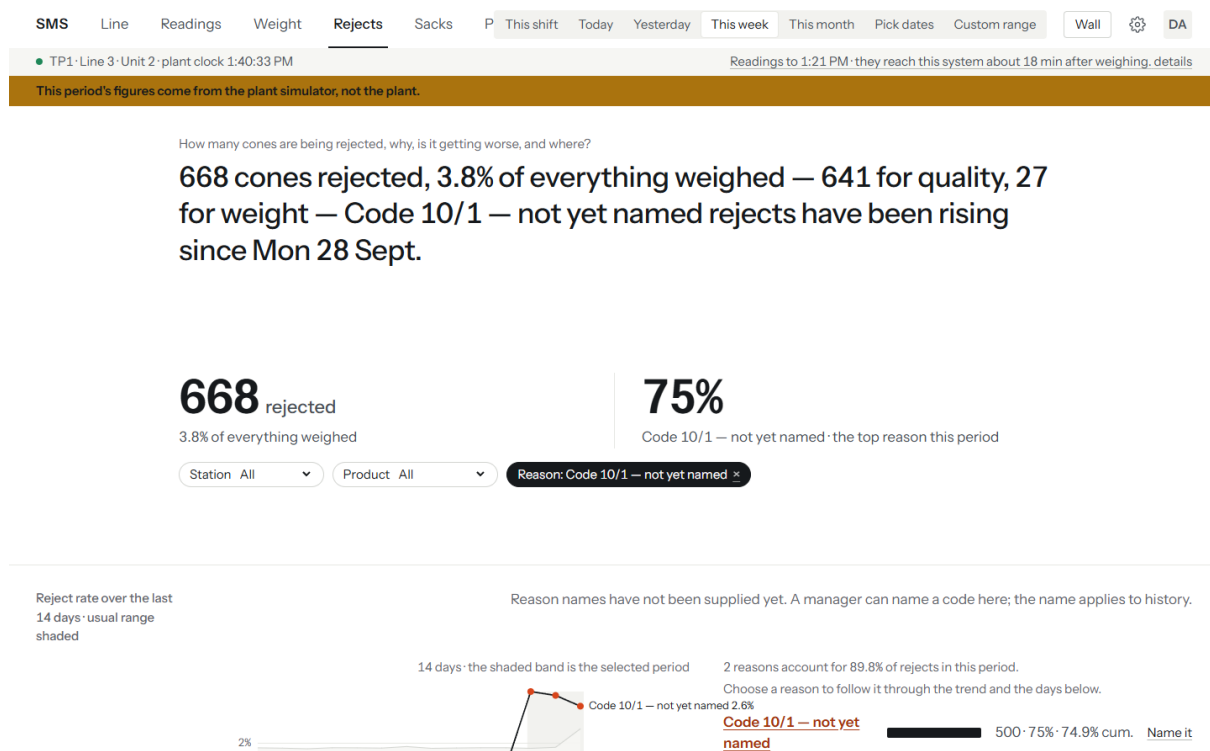


Figure 36 — Rejects with the reason Code 10/1 chosen: a dark chip "Reason: Code 10/1" appears beside the station and product boxes and the headline changes to describe only that reason.

Part	What it tells you
Headline	Total rejected, the share of everything weighed, the split between quality and weight rejects, and whether the rate is rising.
Reject rate over the last 14 days	The line is the reject rate; the shaded band is the usual range; the darker band marks your chosen period.
Reasons list	Each reason with its count, share and running total. Two reasons make up about 90% of rejects in the demo.
By day and reason	Each production day (06:00 to 06:00) and reason with its rate.
See the rejected cones themselves	Opens Readings filtered to the rejected cones for this period.

The plant supplies only numeric codes such as "Code 10/1"; IFL has not yet said what they mean. An engineer or above can type a name for a code and it applies to all past and future readings. (The note on the Rejects screen says "A manager can name a code here"; the server allows engineers too.)

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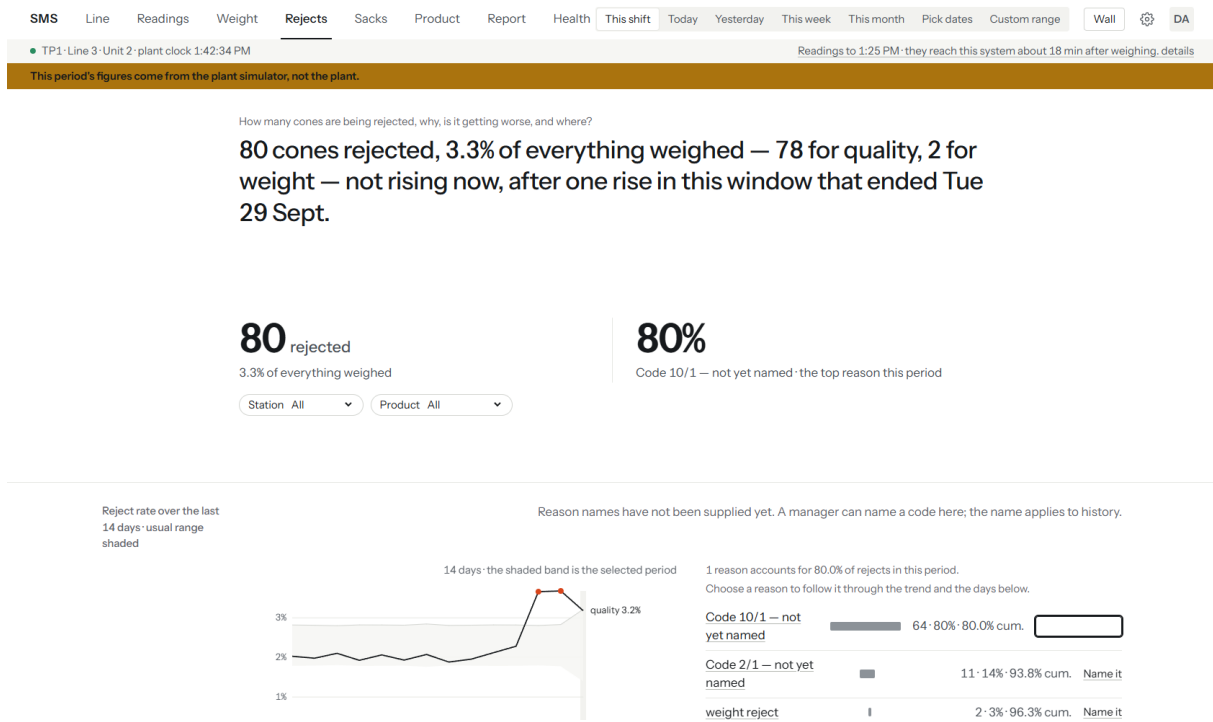


Figure 37 — Rejects, This shift: the first reason's name box is open in the reasons list (an empty outlined box beside the bar). Nothing was saved.

1. Find the reason in the list and press **Name it**.
2. Type the name and confirm it.

7.6 Sacks: how many sacks and what is in stock

Sacks reports on sacks weighed, their weight, and a running line stock.

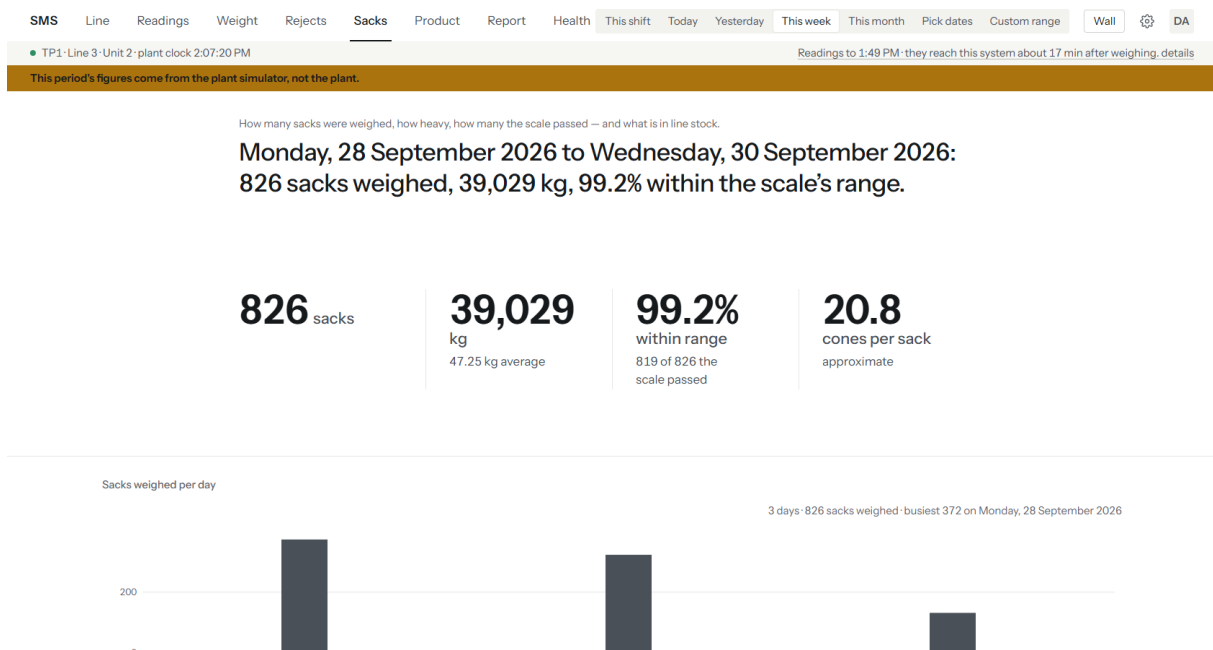


Figure 38 — Sacks, This week: 826 sacks, 39,029 kg, 99.2% within range, 20.8 cones per sack, and the sacks-per-day chart. The blocks below (By product, By shift, Stock ledger, Sack history) are not in this picture.

1. Press **Sacks** and choose a period.

2. Read the headline and the four figures.
3. Scroll to By shift to compare Morning, Evening and Night.
4. Scroll to Stock ledger for the line's stock, opening and closing per day.
5. Press any row of the Sack history to open the sack's record.

Part	What it tells you
"cones per sack, approximate"	An estimate only; the plant records no link between a cone and its sack.
By product	Sacks grouped by product. On the demo all sacks say "No product on the reading", because sack readings carry no product.
Stock ledger	Opening stock, receipts (each sack weighed counts as a receipt), issues, consumption, adjustments and closing. It is stock for the whole line, never per machine: the plant's sack records carry no machine.

Press a day in the ledger to see that day's movements.

Friday, 25 September 2026 · production day
Close · Esc

Friday, 25 September 2026

336 sacks weighed this day (15,874 kg) count as receipts.

No movements were recorded by hand this day.

A correction is a new row that says why; nothing recorded here is edited or deleted. Stock is kept for the line, not per machine: the plant's sack record carries no machine or station at any layer, the sack scale publishes no machine, and this system does not infer one from which cones were weighed around a sack. IFL answered on 15 Sep 2026 that sack stock means production per shift, which the production figures on this report already give.

Figure 39 — A day in the stock ledger, Friday 25 September: 336 sacks (15,874 kg) counted as receipts and no movements recorded by hand.

An engineer or above can record a movement made by hand, such as sacks issued.

Stock ledger

line stock, not per machine

Sacks

kg

What happened

Sacks

kg (if known)

Product

Issued out

Not stated

When (plant time)

09/30/2026 01:42 PM

Why

Record

Cancel

A correction is a new row that says why; nothing recorded here is edited or deleted.

7,144 sacks in stock before this period. 7,275 sacks in stock at the end of it.

Day	Opening	Receipts	Issues	Consumption	Adjustments	Closing
Wednesday, 30 September 2026	7,144	131	0	0	0	7,275

Per machine **not available** — Stock is kept for the line, not per machine: the plant's sack record carries no machine or station at any layer, the sack scale publishes no machine, and this system does not infer one from which cones were weighed around a sack. IFL answered on 15 Sep 2026 that sack stock means production per shift, which the production figures on this report already give.

Every sack weighed at the packing scale counts as a receipt into line stock; that reading of "receipt", and whether the ledger is kept in sacks or kg, are not yet confirmed by IFL. A sack's time is when the plant wrote the reading, which can trail the weighing.

Figure 40 — The stock movement form: what happened (Issued out), number of sacks, kg if known, product, when, why, Record and Cancel. Cancelled when captured.

- 1. Press **Record a movement** in the Stock ledger.
- 2. Choose what happened, and enter the sacks (or kg), the plant time and a reason.
- 3. Press **Record**. Nothing recorded can be edited or deleted; a correction is a new row that says why.

7.7 Product: what is running, and how to change it

Product has four tabs: **Running**, **Changeover**, **Catalogue** and **History**.

7.7.1 Running

Products in force now

The same reading window Line uses, grouped by product instead of by machine.

DEMO-21

Station 1	for at least 2 h · 60 cones ›	Readings
Station 2	for at least 2 h · 42 cones ›	Readings
Station 3	for at least 2 h · 44 cones ›	Readings
Station 4	for at least 2 h · 36 cones ›	Readings
Station 5	for at least 2 h · 51 cones ›	Readings

DEMO-20

Station 6	for at least 2 h · 40 cones ›	Readings
Station 7	for at least 2 h · 37 cones ›	Readings
Station 8	for at least 2 h · 41 cones ›	Readings
Station 9	for at least 2 h · 46 cones ›	Readings

DEMO-1021

Station 10	for at least 2 h · 40 cones ›	Readings
Station 11	for at least 2 h · 34 cones ›	Readings

DEMO-1022

Station 12	for at least 2 h · 47 cones ›	Readings
------------	----------------------------------	--------------------------

DEMO-1023

Station 13	for at least 2 h · 39 cones ›	Readings
------------	----------------------------------	--------------------------

DEMO-1024 (retired in PDAS)

This product is marked retired in PDAS but is still being produced — worth checking.

Station 14	for at least 2 h · 41 cones ›	Readings
------------	----------------------------------	--------------------------

From each machine's newest cones, in the two hours ending Wed 30 Sept, 1:49 PM — the newest reading on record.

This window is anchored on that reading, not on the selected period, and does not move with it.

Read from Simulator data batch 1, one data batch.

Figure 41 — Product, Running tab, the "Products in force now" block: six products with their stations. DEMO-1024 on station 14 is marked "(retired in PDAS)" with the note "This product is marked retired in PDAS but is still being produced - worth checking."

The tab lists each product currently being made and the stations making it, using the same readings as Line. A product marked "(retired in PDAS)" that is still being produced deserves a check: someone retired it in the product database but a station still runs it.

To record the line's product in SMS (engineer or above):

1. On the Running tab, press **Change**.

2. Pick the product and give a reason if you wish.
3. Press **Record this product**.

The screenshot shows the IFL Sack Management System interface. At the top, there is a navigation bar with tabs: SMS, Line, Readings, Weight, Rejects, Sacks, **Product**, Report, and Health. Below the navigation bar, there is a status bar with a green dot and text: "TP1-Line 3-Unit 2-plant clock 1:42:46 PM". To the right of the status bar, there is a text label: "Readings to 1:25 PM - they reach this system about 18 min after weighing, details". Below the status bar, there is a brown banner with white text: "The live line status comes from the plant simulator, not the plant." Below the banner, there is a text label: "What is each machine running, what are its limits, and how do I change it." Below the text label, there is a heading: "Product". Below the heading, there is a row of tabs: **Running**, Changeover, Catalogue, and History. Below the tabs, there is a form with the following fields: "Product recorded in this system" (No product has been recorded for this line yet.), "Change" (a dropdown menu with a minus sign), "Why (optional)" (a text input field), "Record this product" (a button), and "Cancel" (a button). Below the form, there is a text label: "Recorded here for weight limits and reports. It is not sent to the machine." Below the text label, there is a table with the following data:

Products in force now	The same reading window Line uses, grouped by product instead of by machine.
DEMO-21	
Station 1	for at least 2 h - 62 cones
Station 2	for at least 2 h - 44 cones

Figure 42 — The Running tab with the Change form open: a product picker, an optional reason, Record this product and Cancel.

This records the product in SMS for weight limits and reports only. It is not sent to the machine.

7.7.2 Changeover

The Changeover tab plans a product change and checks it for problems before anything is written.

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SMSLineReadingsWeightRejectsSacksProductReportHealthThis shiftTodayYesterdayThis weekThis monthPick datesCustom rangeWall⚙️DA

● TP1-Line 3-Unit 2-plant clock 1:44:43 PMReadings to 1:26 PM: they reach this system about 18 min after weighing. details

What is each machine running, what are its limits, and how do I change it.

Product

RunningChangeoverCatalogueHistory

Changeover

Blend

—Add

Count

—Add

Tube type

—Add

Target (g)

1960

Below target (g)

30

Above target (g)

30

Lot / description

PP colour

Sack colour

Retire

☐ DEMO-20 (20)

☐ DEMO-21 (21)

☐ DEMO-1021 (1021)

☐ DEMO-1022 (1022)

☐ DEMO-1023 (1023)

☐ DEMO-1023 · Demo pallet 1023 · DEMO-LOT-1023 (25)

☐ DEMO-1022 · Demo pallet 1022 · DEMO-LOT-1022 (24)

☐ DEMO-1021 · Demo pallet 1021 · DEMO-LOT-1021 (23)

☐ DEMO-21 · Demo pallet 21 · DEMO-LOT-21 (22)

☐ DEMO-20 · Demo pallet 20 · DEMO-LOT-20 (21)

Why is this changing? (required)

Please give a reason of at least 10 characters.

Check the plan

A changeover plan always includes a blend, count and tube type. Pick an existing one for each (or add a new one) — even if you only mean to retire a product or pallet below.

No changeover has been planned yet.

Figure 43 — Changeover tab, empty: pickers for blend, count and tube type, Target 1960 g, below and above 30 g, lot and colours, a Retire checklist, a required reason and the Check the plan button.

1. Pick an existing blend, count and tube type, or press the **Add** link beside one to create a new one.
2. Set the target weight and the amounts below and above it, and type a lot / description (the plan is blocked without one).
3. Tick anything to retire, and type the reason (at least 10 characters).
4. Press **Check the plan**.
5. Read the plan and any Blockers.

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SMS

Line

Readings

Weight

Rejects

Sacks

Product

Report

Health

This shift

Today

Yesterday

This week

This month

Pick dates

Custom range

Wall

⚙

DA

TP1-Line 3-Unit 2-plant clock 1:42:53 PM

Readings to 1:25 PM: they reach this system about 18 min after weighing, details

What is each machine running, what are its limits, and how do I change it.

Product

Running

Changeover

Catalogue

History

Changeover

Blend

DEMO BLEND A

Add

Count

1.2D

Add

Tube type

Demo tube 70g (70 g) · form 1

Add

Target (g)

1960

Below target (g)

30

Above target (g)

30

Lot / description

PP colour

Sack colour

Retire

☐ DEMO-20 (20)

☐ DEMO-21 (21)

☐ DEMO-1021 (1021)

☐ DEMO-1022 (1022)

☐ DEMO-1023 (1023)

☐ DEMO-1023 · Demo pallet 1023 · DEMO-LOT-1023 (25)

☐ DEMO-1022 · Demo pallet 1022 · DEMO-LOT-1022 (24)

☐ DEMO-1021 · Demo pallet 1021 · DEMO-LOT-1021 (23)

☐ DEMO-21 · Demo pallet 21 · DEMO-LOT-21 (22)

☐ DEMO-20 · Demo pallet 20 · DEMO-LOT-20 (21)

Why is this changing? (required)

DEMO dry run for the guide screenshots

Check the plan

What this changeover would do

blend	DEMO BLEND A name: DEMO BLEND A	reuse
count	1.2D name: 1.2D	reuse
tube_type	Demo tube 70g name: Demo tube 70g · tubeWeightG: 70 · tubeForm: 1	reuse
material	DEMO BLEND A · 1.2D · Demo tube 70g · CreateMaterial setpointG: 1960 · offsetMinusG: 30 · offsetPlusG: 30 · limits: 1,960 ± 30 g · active: yes	create
pallet	CreatePallet packSchemalId: 1 · active: yes · labelType: 1	create

Target and limits 1,960 ± 30 g

Blockers
These stop the changeover; it cannot run until each is resolved.
The lot name is required: it becomes the material's description and the pallet's lot.
PDAS allows only one product per blend + count + tube type, active or not: DEMO BLEND A · 1.2D · Demo tube 70g already exists as product 20 (DEMO-20). Change one of the three, or change the limits on product 20 instead.

PDAS has no transaction across its procedures and SMS never deletes: a step that succeeds stays written even if a later step fails. If that happens, the ids already created are listed here, and a retry reuses them.
This makes the product available in PDAS and records what was intended. The operator still selects it on the OCS panel at the machine.

Executing a changeover here is switched off until a full test of this feature has been run and passed on this computer. The plan below can still be checked.
Writing to PDAS was switched off in this system's settings.

Execute the changeover

Figure 44 — Changeover dry run: DEMO BLEND A, 1.2D and Demo tube 70g re-used, a new material and pallet planned, a Blocker saying that product already exists as product 20, and a greyed Execute the changeover button.

The plan lists each step (re-use or create) and lists **Blockers** in red. Here the blocker says PDAS allows only one product per blend, count and tube type, so this plan cannot run; the fix it suggests is to change the limits of the existing product instead.

Warning: Executing a changeover is switched off in this release. The button **Execute the changeover** stays greyed and the screen says why: writing to PDAS is disabled until a full test has passed on the plant PC. The plan can still be checked as often as you like; checking never writes anything. See section 6.4 for the conditions for turning writes on. Also, retiring a product and

creating it again with the same blend, count and tube type cannot work, by PDAS's own design; change the limits of the existing product instead.

7.7.3 Catalogue

SMS Line Readings Weight Rejects Sacks **Product** Report Health This shift Today Yesterday This week This month Pick dates Custom range Wall DA

TP1: Line 3 Unit 2 plant clock 1:44:43 PM Readings to 1:26 PM: they reach this system about 18 min after weighing, details

What is each machine running, what are its limits, and how do I change it.

Product

Running Changeover **Catalogue** History

Product catalogue

Every product recorded in PDAS, its limits, and how to add, retire or re-limit one.

These are written to PDAS through its own procedures, as the process engineer does by hand today. Nothing is sent to a machine.

Changing products in PDAS is not available here: Writing to PDAS was switched off in this system's settings.

DEMO-20	20	1,950 g - 1,925 g - 1,975 g
DEMO-21	21	1,950 g - 1,925 g - 1,975 g
DEMO-1021	1021	1,950 g - 1,925 g - 1,975 g
DEMO-1022	1022	1,950 g - 1,925 g - 1,975 g
DEMO-1023	1023	1,950 g - 1,925 g - 1,975 g
DEMO-1024-retired	1024	1,950 g - 1,925 g - 1,975 g

Pallets in PDAS

Pallets make a product selectable on the QCS panel. Only active pallets are offered on the machine. Nothing is sent to a machine from here.

Changing products in PDAS is not available here: Writing to PDAS was switched off in this system's settings.

25	DEMO-1023	Pallet 4x5	DEMO-LOT-1023	Demo pallet 1023
24	DEMO-1022	Sack 3x4	DEMO-LOT-1022	Demo pallet 1022
23	DEMO-1021	Sack 3x4	DEMO-LOT-1021	Demo pallet 1021
22	DEMO-21	Pallet 4x5	DEMO-LOT-21	Demo pallet 21
21	DEMO-20	Pallet 4x5	DEMO-LOT-20	Demo pallet 20
26	DEMO-1024	Pallet 4x5	DEMO-LOT-1024	Demo pallet 1024 (retired material) - retired

Product limits

Product limits

The versioned history this system judges every reading by — each reading by the limits in force at its own time. Changing a limit here records a NEW version; it never rewrites or removes an old one, and readings already recorded keep the limits that were in force when they were weighed.

DEMO-20 [Change limits](#)

Limits	In force from	Source	By	Reason
1,950 ± 25 g	Sat 29 Aug 11:02 AM	pdas_created	—	In force since this material was created in PDAS (dbo.Materials.Timestamp).

DEMO-21 [Change limits](#)

Limits	In force from	Source	By	Reason
1,950 ± 25 g	Sat 29 Aug 11:02 AM	pdas_created	—	In force since this material was created in PDAS (dbo.Materials.Timestamp).

DEMO-1021 [Change limits](#)

Limits	In force from	Source	By	Reason
1,950 ± 25 g	Sat 29 Aug 11:02 AM	pdas_created	—	In force since this material was created in PDAS (dbo.Materials.Timestamp).

DEMO-1022 [Change limits](#)

Limits	In force from	Source	By	Reason
1,950 ± 25 g	Sat 29 Aug 11:02 AM	pdas_created	—	In force since this material was created in PDAS (dbo.Materials.Timestamp).

DEMO-1023 [Change limits](#)

Limits	In force from	Source	By	Reason
1,950 ± 25 g	Sat 29 Aug 11:02 AM	pdas_created	—	In force since this material was created in PDAS (dbo.Materials.Timestamp).

DEMO-1024-retired [Change limits](#)

Limits	In force from	Source	By	Reason
1,950 ± 25 g	Sat 29 Aug 11:02 AM	pdas_created	—	In force since this material was created in PDAS (dbo.Materials.Timestamp).

"No later than" marks a version first seen at that instant, not known to have started then; the oldest one is a lower bound.

Figure 45 — Catalogue tab: every product recorded in PDAS with its target and limits, the pallets, and the versioned limits history with a Change limits link per product; a notice says writing to PDAS is switched off.

The tab shows products, pallets and each product's limits history. Every reading is judged by the limits in force when it was weighed, so changing a limit adds a new version and never rewrites the old ones. To change a limit in SMS (engineer or above):

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1. Press **Change limits** beside the product.
2. Enter the target and the amounts below and above it, and a reason.
3. Press **Save**.

(dbo.Materials.Timestamp).

Change weight limits — DEMO-20 · DEMO
BLEND A · 1.2D · Demo tube 70g (product 20)

This records a new limits version in SMS. It does not change PDAS or the product master.

Target (g)

Below target (g)

Above target (g)

Why (optional)

Save

DEMO-21						Change limits
Limits	In force from	Source	By	Reason		
1,950 ± 25 g	Sat 29 Aug 11:02 AM	pdas_created	—	In force since this material was created in PDAS (dbo.Materials.Timestamp).		

DEMO-1021						Change limits
Limits	In force from	Source	By	Reason		
1,950 ± 25 g	Sat 29 Aug 11:02 AM	pdas_created	—	In force since this material was created in PDAS (dbo.Materials.Timestamp).		

DEMO-1022						Change limits
Limits	In force from	Source	By	Reason		
1,950 ± 25 g	Sat 29 Aug 11:02 AM	pdas_created	—	In force since this material was created in PDAS (dbo.Materials.Timestamp).		

DEMO-1023						Change limits
Limits	In force from	Source	By	Reason		

Figure 46 — The Change weight limits form for DEMO-20: Target 1950, Below target 25, Above target 25, an optional Why box, Save and Cancel. Nothing was saved.

The form says this records a new limits version in SMS and does not change PDAS or the product master.

7.7.4 History

SMS Line Readings Weight Rejects Sacks **Product** Report Health This shift Today Yesterday This week This month Pick dates Custom range Wall ⚙ DA

TP1 · Line 3 · Unit 2 · plant clock 1:44:43 PM Readings to 1:26 PM · they reach this system about 18 min after weighing. details

What is each machine running, what are its limits, and how do I change it.

Product

Running Changeover Catalogue **History**

History

No product change has been recorded for this line yet.

Product change history

No product change has been recorded for this line yet.

Figure 47 — History tab: both blocks read "No product change has been recorded for this line yet."

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The trail of product changes made through SMS. On the demo none has been made, so both blocks are empty.

7.8 Report: printable and exportable reports

Report produces the reports IFL asked for, for the period in the top bar.

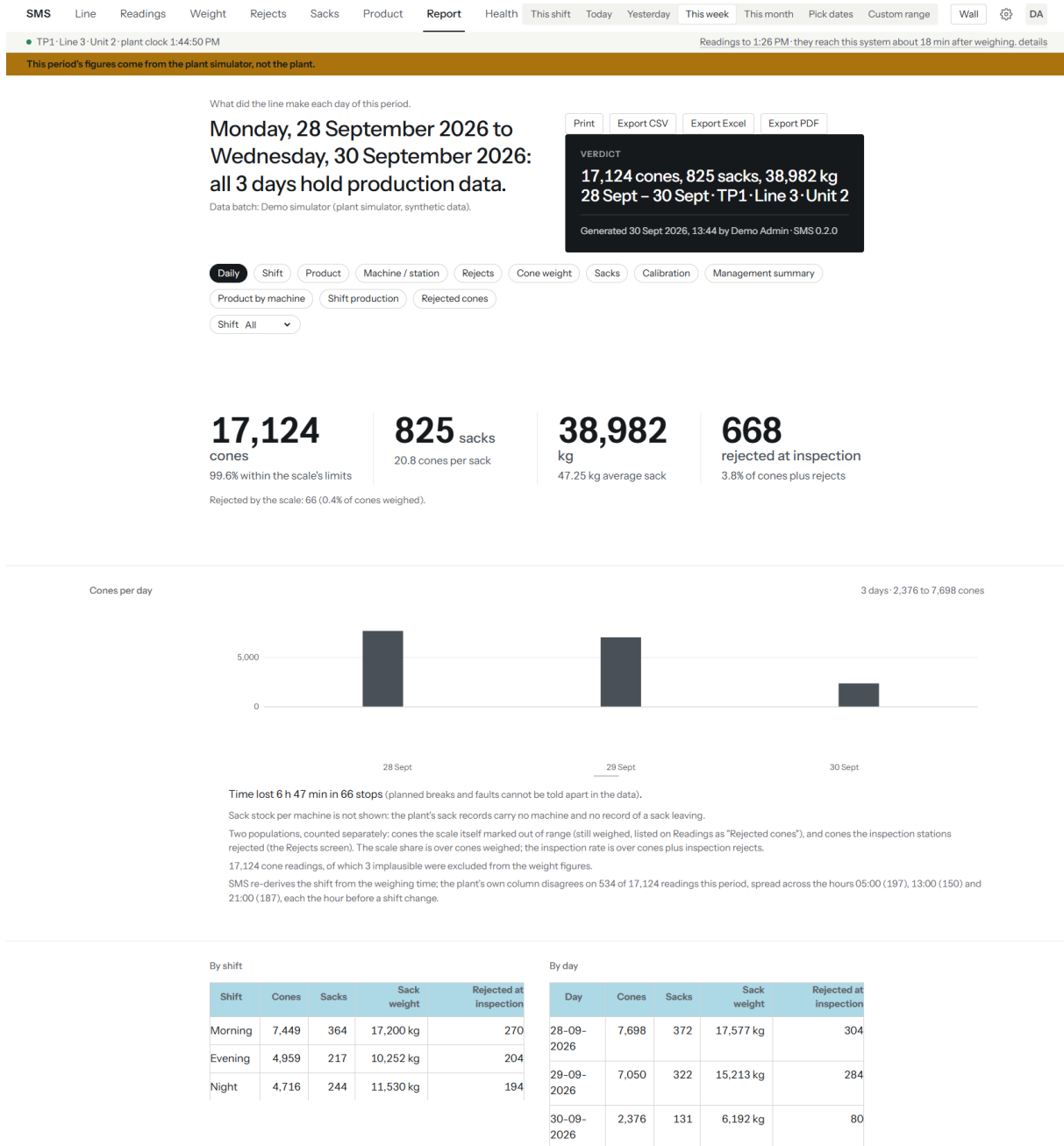


Figure 48 — Report, Daily, This week: the report type buttons, the Print and Export buttons, a dark verdict panel with the totals and who generated it, KPIs, the cones-per-day chart and the By shift and By day tables.

1. Press **Report** and choose a period.
2. Choose the report type from the row of buttons under the verdict.
3. Use the extra boxes that appear for some types (Shift, Station) to narrow it.
4. Press **Print** to print, or one of the Export buttons to download.

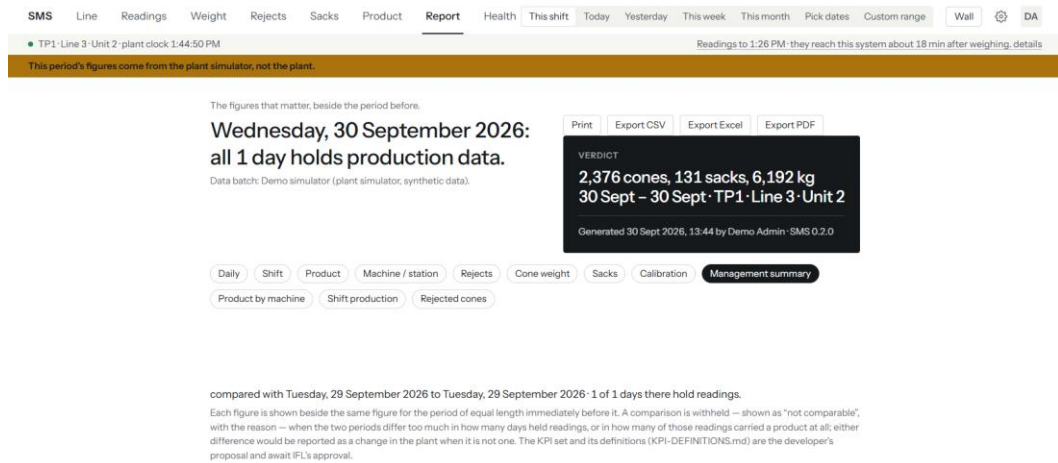
The report types are Daily, Shift, Product, Machine / station, Rejects, Cone weight, Sacks, Calibration, Management summary, Product by machine, Shift production and Rejected cones.

Part	What it tells you
Verdict panel	The headline totals, the period, the line and who generated the report and when, with the SMS version.
Data batch line	The source of the data. On the demo it says the data is synthetic.
KPIs and charts	The figures for the period, then the same data by shift and by day.
Notes under the chart	Time lost, what the report does not know (for example no sack stock per machine), and how the shift was worked out.
Export CSV, Export Excel, Export PDF	Download the report as a file. Needs manager rank. The file carries the same period and provenance as the screen.
Print	Opens the browser's print dialog. Reports print landscape.

Print and Export were used only by pressing the buttons and are not shown as screenshots, because the files and print dialog open outside the browser page.

The management summary sets each figure beside the same figure for the period just before it.

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Figure

Figure	This period	Period before	Change	awaiting IFL's approval
Cones weighed: higher is better	2,376 cones	7,050 cones	-4,674 (-66.3%)	awaiting IFL's approval
Cones in range: higher is better	99.5%	99.7%	-0.2 (-0.2%)	awaiting IFL's approval
Rejected by the scale: lower is better	12 cones	24 cones	-12 (-50.0%)	awaiting IFL's approval
Rejected at inspection: lower is better	80 cones	284 cones	-204 (-71.8%)	awaiting IFL's approval
Inspection reject rate: lower is better	3.3%	3.9%	-0.6 (-15.8%)	awaiting IFL's approval
Within product limits: higher is better	99.3%	99.3%	0	awaiting IFL's approval
Mean cone weight	1,951.3 g	1,951.3 g	-0.0 (-0.0%)	awaiting IFL's approval
Cone weight spread: lower is better	9.0 g	8.8 g	+0.2 (+2.3%)	awaiting IFL's approval
Implausible readings excluded: lower is better	0 readings	0 readings	0	awaiting IFL's approval
Sacks weighed: higher is better	131 sacks	322 sacks	-191 (-59.3%)	awaiting IFL's approval
Sack weight: higher is better	6,191.6 kg	15,212.6 kg	-9,021.0 (-59.3%)	awaiting IFL's approval
Average sack	47.3 kg	47.2 kg	+0.0 (+0.0%)	awaiting IFL's approval
Cones per sack (approx.)	18 cones	22 cones	-4 (-17.4%)	awaiting IFL's approval
Time lost: lower is better	48 min	3 h 29 min	-2 h 41 min	awaiting IFL's approval
Stoppages: lower is better	9 stops	28 stops	-19 (-67.9%)	awaiting IFL's approval
Stations flagged for drift: lower is better	0 stations	0 stations	0	awaiting IFL's approval
Days with readings	1 days	1 days	0	awaiting IFL's approval

Products run

Product	This period	Period before
DEMO-20	633	1,903
DEMO-21	895	2,586
DEMO-1021	318	1,044
DEMO-1022	194	525
DEMO-1023	159	490
DEMO-1024 (retired in PDAS)	177	502
No product on the reading	0	0

Figure 49 — Management summary, This shift: each KPI this period against the period before, a Change column and "awaiting IFL's approval" on every row, then Products run. The demo shows one day, so the figures compare a partial day with a full one.

Every row says "awaiting IFL's approval" because the choice and definition of these figures is the developer's proposal and IFL has not yet approved it.

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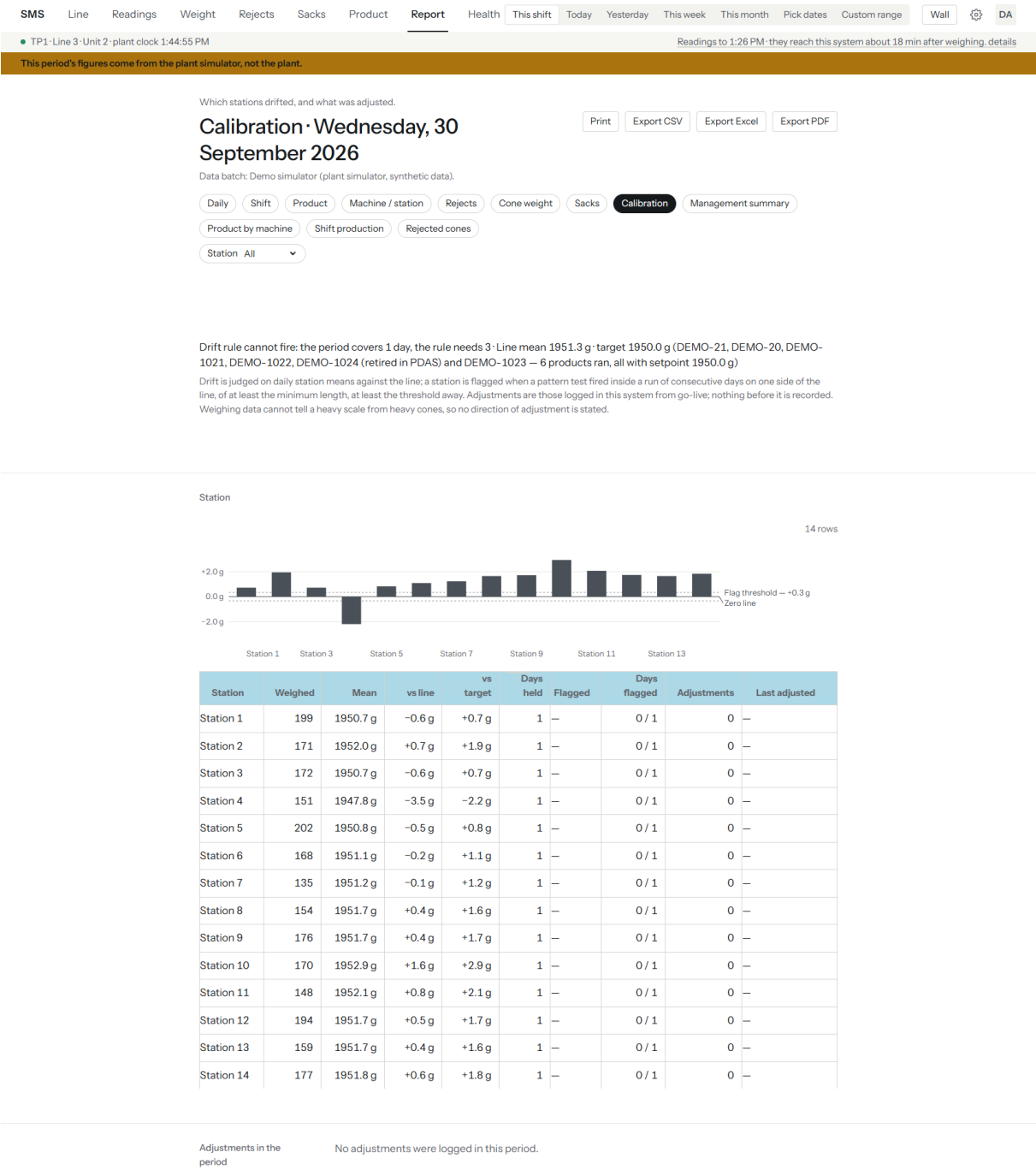


Figure 50 — Calibration report, This shift: a note that the drift rule cannot fire with only one day, a chart of each station's average against the line, a station table and "No adjustments were logged in this period".

The calibration report needs several days to judge drift, so it says so rather than showing a verdict for one shift. Choose **This week** or longer.

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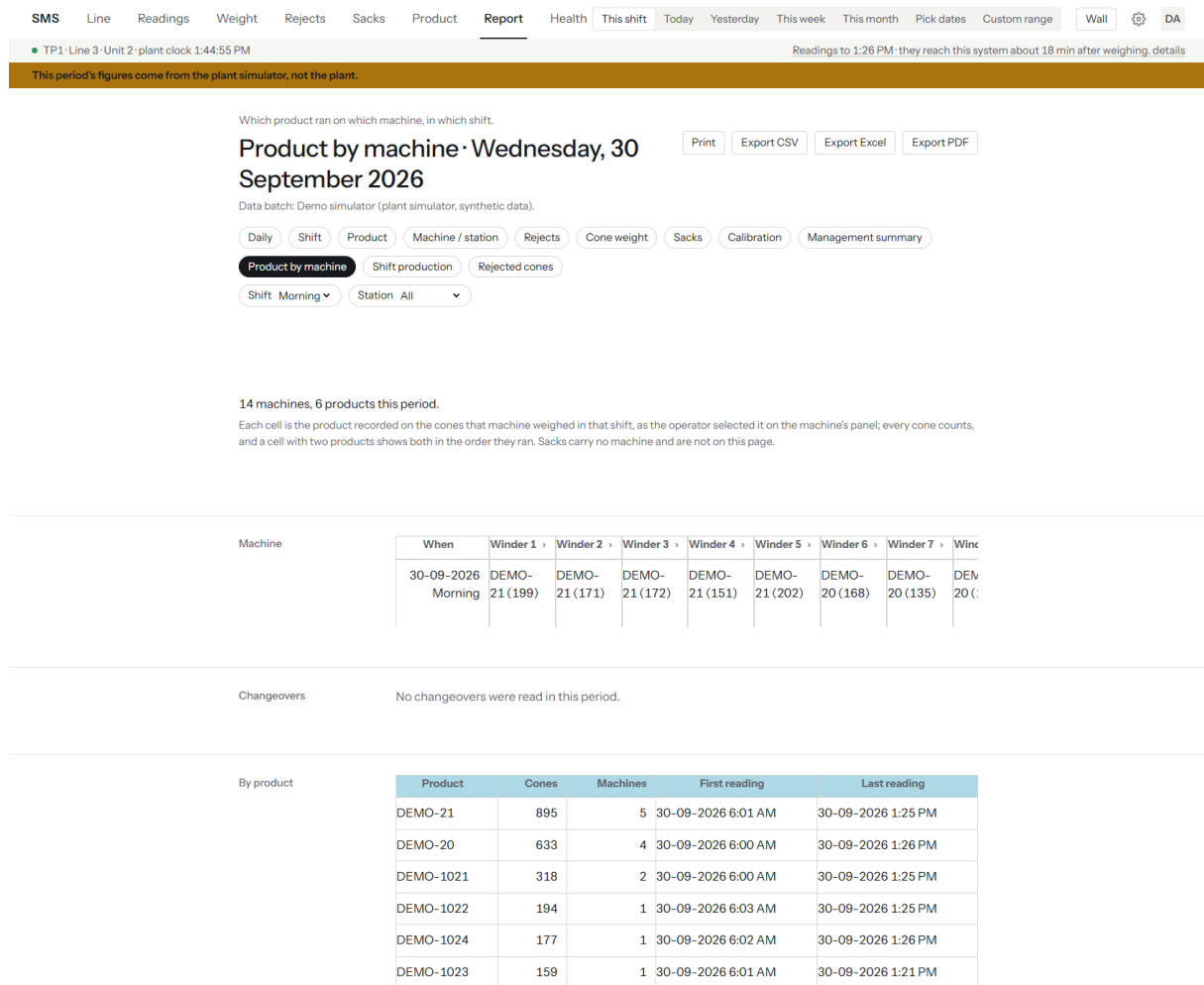


Figure 51 — Product by machine, Morning shift: one row per shift and one column per winder showing the product and cone count; the table is wider than the screen and scrolls sideways (winder 8 is cut off at the edge). Below are Changeovers and By product.

In Product by machine each cell is the product recorded on the machine for that shift, with the cones it weighed in brackets. A cell with two products lists both in the order they ran. On paper this report says the same data is in the CSV export, because it is too wide to print.

7.9 Wall: the fullscreen display

The wall display is for a screen or TV that people read from across the room. It has no menus and refreshes itself.

Line 3 is running

2,376

cones · 99.5% within the scale's limits

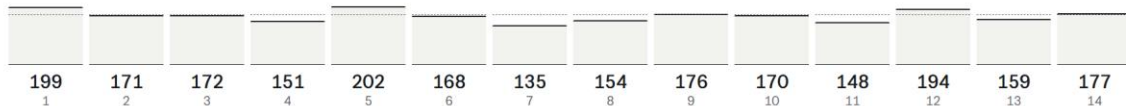
131

sacks · 6,192 kg

80

rejected

Stations — cones this shift



● Readings to 1:26 PM · they reach this system about 18 min after weighing · this board is showing the plant simulator, not the plant

Last sack 47.26 kg 1:41 PM · Last cone 1,953 g 1:26 PM

Figure 52 — The wall display on the simulator: "Line 3 is running", 2,376 cones (99.5% within limits), 131 sacks (6,192 kg), 80 rejected, one bar and count per station, and a footer with the data delay and the last sack and cone.

1. Press **Wall** in the top bar.
2. Leave it up. It updates by itself.
3. Press Esc or use the browser's back button to return.

Part	What it tells you
Line name and state	Whether the line is running, in very large type.
Clock and shift	Plant time and the current shift.
The three figures	Cones, sacks and rejected for this shift.
Station bars	One bar per station, with the count under it. A shorter bar is a station making fewer cones than the others.
Footer	The data delay, and the last sack and cone. On the demo it also says the board shows the simulator.

7.10 Health: is SMS itself working?

Health reports on SMS itself, not on the line: the plant link, the database, the service and the backups. Open it from the top bar.

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SMSLineReadingsWeightRejectsSacksProductReportHealth

This shiftTodayYesterdayThis weekThis monthPick datesCustom range

Wall⚙️DA

TP1: Line 3 - Unit 2 - plant clock 2:07:20 PM

Readings to 1:49 PM: they reach this system about 17 min after weighing, details

The live line status comes from the plant simulator, not the plant.

Is this system itself healthy: the plant link, the database, the service, and the backups.

Health

Something needs attention.

Sync health

The plant connection is healthy.

Source: IFL SQL Server, read-only. There is no PLC connection.

Freshness, the acquisition lag and the newest reading above are all measured from Simulator data batch 1, one batch of recorded data.

Last successful pass16 s ago

Oldest tablecone_raw

Plant connectionreachable at the last pass (30/09/2026, 14:07:02)

Blocking findingsNone

► Data quality findings

► Per table

PDAS write checking

PDAS writes: off

This installation is not writing to PDAS. There is nothing to check.

Figure 53 — Health on the demo: "Something needs attention", and the Sync health block reporting that the plant connection is healthy, with the PDAS write checking block below it. The demo has no backup, so the screen reports as degraded; the blocks further down are not in this picture.

Note: This demo reads "Something needs attention" for one reason only: no backup has been taken (the Backups block says so). On a healthy live installation the headline reads as healthy. Do not treat the demo as an example of a clean install.

1. Press **Health**.
2. Read the headline, then any block shown in red.
3. Open the collapsed lines (Data quality findings, Per table, Readings by state) for detail.
4. If something is red, follow section 8.

Sync health

The plant connection is healthy.

Source: IFL SQL Server, read-only. There is no PLC connection.

Freshness, the acquisition lag and the newest reading above are all measured from Simulator data batch 1, one batch of recorded data.

Last successful pass4 s ago

Oldest tablecone_raw

Plant connectionreachable at the last pass (30/09/2026, 13:44:54)

Blocking findingsNone

► Data quality findings

► Per table

Figure 54 — The Sync health block: "The plant connection is healthy", last successful pass, oldest table, plant connection time and blocking findings, with Data quality findings and Per table folded away.

PDAS write checking

PDAS writes: off

This installation is not writing to PDAS. There is nothing to check.

Figure 55 — The PDAS write checking block: "PDAS writes: off. This installation is not writing to PDAS. There is nothing to check."

Block	What it tells you
Sync health	Whether the sync worker is reading the plant, when it last succeeded, and whether any finding blocks it.
PDAS write checking	Whether SMS is allowed to write to the product database. Off unless deliberately enabled.
Reconciliation	A census of the readings SMS holds. It is not a comparison against IFL's database.
Data batches	Every physical batch of each source table SMS has read, when it was registered and how many rows it holds.
Database	Response time and how much of the 10 GB SQL Server Express limit is used.
Service	The SMS version and how long the service has been running. A short uptime beside an old "since" date means it restarted.
Backups	Whether a backup was found and proven restorable. Red means the nightly job has stopped.
Disk space	Free space on the database and backup volumes.
Last manual verification run	When someone last ran the verify command by hand. It is a record, not a live check.

8 Troubleshooting

In the messages quoted below, `${span}` and `${since}` are placeholders: SMS replaces each with an actual time or duration when it shows the message.

Symptom	Likely cause	Fix
Line's headline reads has had no readings for <code>\${span}</code> — the line, or the plant's data recorder, may have stopped on a line you know is running	The ~18-minute acquisition lag (see section 1.2) — the newest reading has not arrived yet, which is normal, not a fault.	Check the lag sentence under the top bar first. If the stated lag is much larger than usual, treat it as the next row instead.
The lag sentence reads No new readings since <code>\${since}</code> — the plant link may be down.	The sync worker has not delivered a new reading recently — a real connectivity or service problem, not the normal acquisition lag.	Check SMS-Sync is running. Check Health 's sync block for the failing table. Check the plant's own SQL Server is reachable from this machine.
sync halts, reporting an unregistered source generation	IFL's source tables were rebuilt (dropped and recreated with identities restarted) — a new generation. This is expected behaviour, not a bug — see section 1.4.	Run <code>node cli/dist/index.js epoch:list</code> to see it, then <code>epoch:accept</code> for it as in section 4.11. Never assume the new generation is a continuation of the old one.
Sign-in fails with a generic error for everyone, including known-good accounts	That username and password did not match. is shown for a wrong password, but also — per a known, open gap — for some database-connection failures, which look identical on screen.	Check <code>GET /api/health</code> and the plant/app database connectivity before assuming every account's password is wrong.
<code>sqlcmd</code> /the app cannot reach the app database at all	<code>APP_DB_SERVER/APP_DB_PORT</code> wrong, SQL Server Express not running, or a firewall blocking the app database port.	Confirm the SQL Server service is running and reachable with <code>sqlcmd</code> directly using the same server/port/login as <code>.env</code> .
PDF export fails or the Export PDF button errors	Microsoft Edge is not installed, or not at the path SMS expects.	Install Edge, or set <code>PDF_EDGE_PATH</code> to its actual location.

Symptom	Likely cause	Fix
Health's Backups block reads No backup file was found.	BACKUP_DIR does not match where the backup script actually writes, or no backup has run yet.	Confirm BACKUP_DIR in .env matches -OutDir in the backup script/scheduled task exactly, and that the scheduled task from section 4.12 has actually run once.
retention --dry-run or a real retention run reports far more or fewer rows than expected	Retention only prunes sms.sync_run (default 90 days, newest row per line/table always kept) and non-CRITICAL sms.dq_finding (default 365 days) — never readings, sms.audit_log, or sms.product_change.	Confirm you are reading the right table's figures; see Appendix A for the two retention keys.
cutover --confirm refuses with exit code 2	The required --backup=<path.bak> flag was left off — DEPLOY.md's own shorthand omits it, but the code requires it.	Always include --backup=<path to a .bak file> — see Appendix B.
user:create refuses with an invalid-role error	An old role name (operator, supervisor) was used.	Use exactly viewer, engineer, manager or admin.
A screen shows a Simulator label, or a sentence saying the figures shown are the plant simulator's and not the plant's, on what should be the live plant	The installation is pointed at a demonstration/simulator database, not the real plant. This should never appear on a live installation.	Confirm IFL_DB_SERVER/IFL_DB_NAME_DATA/IFL_DB_NAME_PDAS in .env point at the plant's own server and databases, not a _SIM copy.
A DQ finding or a "needs attention" state appears on Health that you do not recognise	See the Sync health and DQ blocks on Setup for which table and which finding.	Read the finding's own stated text — SMS states in words what it could not do and why, rather than a bare error code. If the cause is still unclear, it is a question for whoever maintains SMS's own code, not something this guide can resolve generically.
Weight basis or shift-boundary figures look wrong for this plant	WEIGHT_BASIS/SHIFT_MODE are not yet confirmed by IFL for every plant — see Appendix C, item 12.	Do not change these keys without a written answer from IFL; the app states plainly wherever this is unconfirmed.

Symptom	Likely cause	Fix
Health stays at Something needs attention. because of a data finding that is real and needs no action (for example a recorded weight of exactly 0)	Known data findings do not clear themselves.	An engineer (rank 2 or above) opens the finding under Data quality findings , presses Acknowledge and writes a reason of at least 10 characters. The finding stops counting against the status and stays visible, with who acknowledged it. Findings that say the software itself is failing (repeated sync failure, a failed transform, an unverified PDAS write) have no Acknowledge button: they must be fixed.
Health says This backup has not been proven restorable. Do not rely on it until it verifies.	The newest .bak has no matching verification marker, or its size no longer matches the marker.	Run backup-appdb.ps1 again by hand and read its output. A backup that fails verification is renamed to end in .unverified; do not rely on it.
Health's Disk space block shows a volume below the warning line	Less than 2 GB is free on the database volume or the backup volume.	Free space, or move backups elsewhere. When it is low, Health reads Something needs attention..
The recorder line on Health shows a check-in time that is old	The sync worker has stopped checking in. A recent check-in beside an old newest reading means the worker is fine and the plant simply has nothing new.	Check SMS-Sync is running.
epoch:accept refuses with a message about an old archive, exit 2	SMS suspects the source is a restored old database, not a new generation. It compares the data itself, because a restore gets today's create date.	Do not override. If the data is IFL's late archive of an existing generation, it belongs with epoch:backfill (Appendix B). Use --i-know-this-is-a-new-generation only on the maintainer's instruction; every use is audited.
A limits change is refused with a message about a large change	The target moved by more than 3 % (or a limit by more than 20 g) in one edit. These two numbers are the developer's defaults.	Tick the large-change box and give a reason of at least 20 characters if the change is intended. See section 6.4.
A request for a period over a year is refused, "range too large"	Production and weight requests are capped at 366 days.	Ask for a shorter period.

If a symptom is not listed here, check `GET /api/health` and the **Health** screen first — both are designed to state what is wrong in plain words rather than a bare error code.

9 Maintenance

9.1 Backups and a restore test

The nightly backup task (registered in section 4.12) runs `backup-appdb.ps1`, which backs up the app database only, checks the file with `RESTORE VERIFYONLY ... WITH CHECKSUM`, and deletes `.bak` files older than 30 days from its output folder (add `-NoPrune` to keep every file for that run):

```
powershell -File scripts\backup-appdb.ps1 -Server "<host>,<port>" -Db sms -Pass "<sms_backup password>" -OutDir "<backup dir>"
```

The scheduled task itself runs it with `-User ''` (a trusted Windows connection via `sqlcmd -E`), so no password needs to be stored for it.

When the check passes, the script writes a small marker file beside the backup, named like the backup with `.verified.json` added. **Health** reads it, so its Backups block can say the newest backup has been proven restorable. If the check fails, the backup file is renamed to end in `.unverified` and the script exits with an error; Health then reports the newest backup that does have a good marker. Keep `BACKUP_DIR` in `.env` the same as the backup folder, or Health will look in the wrong place.

Note: A verified marker proves the file is intact, not that it restores cleanly onto your server. The restore test below is still needed.

Warning: A backup is only worth having if it can be restored. Test this deliberately, on a spare or scratch SQL Server instance, not the live app database — restore the newest `.bak` file with SQL Server's own `RESTORE DATABASE`, and confirm the restored copy opens and its row counts look sane, on a schedule IFL is comfortable with (for example, after every significant configuration change, and at least once a quarter).

Configuration (not the database) is backed up separately, into an ACL-locked folder, and never includes the database itself:

```
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File scripts\backup-config.ps1 -InstallDir "C:\sms" -BackupDir "C:\sms-backups"
```

9.2 Scheduled tasks

The three scheduled tasks registered in section 4.12 run on their own; check any one's history with:

```
schtasks /query /tn "SMS Nightly Backup" /v /fo LIST
```

Substitute "SMS Weekly Maintenance" or "SMS Daily Retention" for the other two.

9.3 Retention

`retention` prunes only `sms.sync_run` history (default 90 days, always keeping the newest row per line/table) and non-CRITICAL `sms.dq_finding` rows (default 365 days) — never readings, `sms.audit_log`, or `sms.product_change`. Preview what a run would remove before running it for real:

```
node cli/dist/index.js retention --dry-run
```

Then, once satisfied:

```
node cli/dist/index.js retention
```

The daily scheduled task already runs this automatically; running it by hand is for checking its behaviour, not something to do routinely.

9.4 Database maintenance

The weekly maintenance task runs SQL Server's own maintenance script directly:

```
sqlcmd -S .\SQLEXPRESS -E -d sms -b -i scripts\db-maintenance.sql
```

9.5 Configuration backup

See section 9.1 above — `backup-config.ps1` is the dedicated tool for this, separate from the database backup.

9.6 Logs and rotation

The API and sync worker write their own log files under `C:\sms\logs`. Check them directly when a service's behaviour does not match what **Health** or `GET /api/health` reports.

9.7 Restarting services

Restart SMS-Api and SMS-Sync from Windows' Services console, or with NSSM's own restart command, whenever `.env` changes — neither process re-reads `.env` while running.

9.8 Upgrade and rollback

1. Take a fresh, verified backup first (see section 9.1).
2. Stop SMS-Api and SMS-Sync.
3. Replace the package contents with the new release (keep the existing `.env` — never overwrite it from `.env.example`).
4. Run `npm ci && npm run build` and `npm run db:migrate` again.
5. Start the services and work through section 5 again.

To roll back, restore the previous release's package contents and the database backup taken immediately before the upgrade, then repeat section 5.

9.9 Health checks worth a glance

Besides the backup verification above, **Health** shows the free space on the database volume and the backup volume, the record of the last manual `verify` run, and when the sync worker last checked in beside the newest reading's own time. A worker that checks in on time and finds nothing new looks different from a dead one only when both times are shown, which is why both are. Findings that are known and need no action can be acknowledged by an engineer (see section 8).

9.10 Loading the missing 10 July to 5 August data

IFL has not yet sent the data between the July and September samples. When it arrives, do not run `epoch:accept` on it: it belongs to a generation SMS already holds. `epoch:backfill` adds it to the end of that generation's raw tables, and refuses everything if its checks fail. Run it first without `--confirm` to read the plan, then with it, then run `rebuild` for the same generation to derive the readings, then

verify with `--source-db` and `--epoch`. This has been proven only on scratch copies of the database. The exact commands are in Appendix B; ask the maintainer before running them for the first time.

9.11 Database size

Health's Database block states the current size against the 10 GB SQL Server Express cap and raises a warning past 80% full (see Appendix C, item 10). How long readings are kept against this cap is IFL's own decision to make — nothing in SMS prunes readings automatically today.

10 Security

10.1 Logins and least privilege

SMS uses five distinct SQL logins, each scoped to exactly what it needs — never one shared login for everything:

Login (generic name)	Access
sms_app	The app database only — the API and sync worker's normal connection.
sms_migrate	The app database only, used solely for running migrations, set in the invoking shell rather than <code>.env</code> .
sms_readonly	db_datareader on IFL's DATA_TP1U2 and PDAS_TP1U2 only — never write access, never any other database.
sms_pdas_writer	A separate login, used only if the PDAS write path in section 6.4 is turned on — distinct from sms_readonly by design, so a compromised read-only connection can never write.
sms_backup	db_backupoperator on the app database, used by the scheduled backup task.

SMS never reuses DATA_TP1U2.Users (IFL's own existing table there holds plaintext passwords) — every SMS account is a fresh, hashed-password account in SMS's own database.

10.2 Protecting .env

`.env` holds every database password SMS uses. Restrict its file permissions to the account the services run as and to administrators only; never email it, commit it to version control, or copy it into a support ticket. `backup-config.ps1` (see section 9.1) copies it into an ACL-locked folder as part of the configuration backup — treat that backup folder with the same care as `.env` itself.

10.3 Password policy

Every account password must be at least `PASSWORD_MIN_LENGTH` characters (default 10, configurable 6–128 — see Appendix A). Passwords are hashed (argon2), never stored or logged in plain text. Resetting a password from **Setup** revokes every existing session for that account immediately.

10.4 Sessions

SMS uses server-side session cookies, not tokens the browser can decode. `COOKIE_SECURE` must be true once served over HTTPS — see section 6.1. Signing out from the user menu's **Sign out** item ends that one session; resetting a password from **Setup** ends every session for that account.

10.5 Roles

See section 6.3 for the full rank table. Every screen is readable by every signed-in account; writing is gated by rank, and **Setup** is the only screen restricted outright, to `admin`.

10.6 Audit log

Every write SMS itself makes — account changes, calibration adjustments, product changes, PDAS write attempts — is recorded in the **Audit log** block on **Setup**, including who made it and when. So are

acknowledgements of data findings (with the reason given) and any use of the `--i-know-this-is-a-new-generation` override on `epoch:accept`.

10.7 TLS

See section 6.5 in Chapter 6 for how to configure it. On an isolated, plant-only LAN, plain HTTP with `COOKIE_SECURE=false` is a defensible choice IFL can make; on any network reachable more broadly, TLS should be turned on.

10.8 Air-gapped operation

The plant PC has no internet access, and SMS is designed around that: no cloud dependency, no email alerting (see Appendix C, item 13), and `GET /api/health` is meant to be polled by whatever monitoring tool the plant already runs on its own network, rather than SMS reaching out itself.

10.9 The separate PDAS writer

See section 6.4. The PDAS write path uses its own login (`sms_pdas_writer`), separate from the read-only login used for everything else, specifically so that turning PDAS writes on or off is a single, auditable switch (`PDAS_WRITE_ENABLED`) that never affects the read-only connection's own permissions.

11 FAQ

Why is the data about 18 minutes old? IFL's own acquisition layer writes a cone's row roughly 18 minutes after the cone is actually weighed — this is measured from IFL's own data, not an SMS delay. SMS states this lag on screen rather than hiding it, and judges whether the line is running against now — that lag. See section 1.2.

Why is there no sack stock per machine? IFL's sack table carries no machine or station column on each sack row — only the sack number, its weight, whether the scale judged it in range, and when the reading was written. Sack stock per machine cannot be computed from data that does not exist, by SMS or by anyone else, without either a PLC integration IFL has deferred or a manual entry screen. See Appendix C, item 2, and the **Sacks** screen's own on-screen note.

Can SMS change the product on a machine? No. The PDAS write path (see section 6.4) can make a product selectable in IFL's product-master database, but it never writes to a machine or a PLC — whether the machine's own controller reads its limits from PDAS live is a separate question for IFL. See Appendix C, item 4.

Is there AI in SMS? No, and SMS does not claim otherwise. What exists is real statistics: a station-drift calibration signal (one control rule, deliberately not eight — see Appendix C, item 11) and a projection of when a drifting station reaches its action limit, worked out from its own recent readings with a stated confidence range. It is a measured trend, not a machine-learning model, and it says so wherever it is shown.

Why does a report only cover part of the period I picked? IFL's source tables have been rebuilt once already (see section 1.4), and a report never silently mixes two generations together as if they were one continuous record. If a period spans a rebuild, the report states which generation it covers and how many readings from another generation were left out.

Why doesn't a station's reject or weight figure match another screen exactly? Every canonical-table query states which source generation it resolved and what it excluded; figures that look close but not identical usually differ because they cover slightly different scopes (a single generation versus a whole window that spans a rebuild) — check each screen's own stated period and generation before assuming a mismatch is a bug.

Why is Health "degraded" when the plant looks fine? Usually a real but harmless data finding, such as two recorded weights of exactly 0, or a backup that has not verified, or low disk space. Health names the reason. An engineer can acknowledge a known data finding with a written reason; findings about the software itself cannot be acknowledged.

What does the Back button in the top bar do? Dragging across a chart zooms the page to that range, and the **Back to previous range** button undoes the zoom.

Why can my report figures differ from IFL's own vendor screen? SMS works out shifts from the time a cone was produced. The vendor's Shift column comes from insert time. Reports carry a footnote saying so.

Who can see what? Every screen listed in Chapter 7 is open to every signed-in account, at every rank. **Setup** is the only screen restricted, to admin. See section 6.3.

Can I trust the "days to the action limit" projection? It is a straight-line projection through a station's recent daily averages, with a stated 90% confidence range on the rate itself — not a forecast

of what the scale will actually do. When the range spans zero, SMS says the drift is not established rather than printing a number that would overstate its own confidence.

12 Contacts and escalation

Role	Contact	When to use
IFL IT / SMS administrator	<IT contact name and phone/email>	Account issues, installation, service restarts, backups.
IFL process department lead	<process department contact>	Questions about how a report or figure should be read, or a request to change a role.
SMS maintainer / developer	<maintainer contact>	A defect, an unclear finding on Health that Chapter 8 does not explain, or a request to extend SMS.
IFL's database administrator	<DBA contact>	The read-only login (sms_readonly), or anything on IFL's own DATA_TP1U2/PDAS_TP1U2 databases.

Note: Fill in the placeholders above with IFL's own current contacts before distributing this guide.

12.1 Escalation order

1. Check **Health** and GET /api/health — both are designed to state what is wrong in plain words.
2. Check section 8 for the symptom.
3. Contact the IFL IT / SMS administrator.
4. If the cause is inside SMS's own code rather than the local environment, the administrator escalates to the SMS maintainer.

A Configuration keys

Every key below lives in `.env` (copied from `.env.example` — see section 4.4). Defaults shown are the template's own defaults, not necessarily what a real plant should use.

Key	Default/example	Meaning
APP_DB_SERVER	<code>.\SQLEXPRESS</code>	App database server.
APP_DB_PORT	1433	App database port (required, no code default).
APP_DB_NAME	<code>sms</code>	App database name.
APP_DB_USER	<code>sms_app</code>	App's own SQL login.
APP_DB_PASSWORD	—	Password for APP_DB_USER.
APP_DB_ENCRYPT	<code>true</code>	TLS to the app database.
APP_DB_TRUST_SERVER_CERTIFICATE	<code>true</code>	Accept a self-signed certificate on the app database.
MIGRATE_DB_USER / MIGRATE_DB_PASSWORD	—	The <code>sms_migrate</code> login, used only for <code>npm run db:migrate</code> , set in the invoking shell rather than <code>.env</code> for a long-running service.
IFL_DB_SERVER	<code>.\SQLEXPRESS</code>	IFL's SQL Server — the dev-vs-live switch.
IFL_DB_PORT	1433	IFL server port (required).
IFL_DB_NAME_DATA	<code>DATA_TP1U2</code>	The weighing-data database name.
IFL_DB_NAME_PDAS	<code>PDAS_TP1U2</code>	The product-master database name.
IFL_DB_USER	<code>sms_readonly</code>	Read-only login into IFL's databases.
IFL_DB_PASSWORD	—	Password for IFL_DB_USER.
IFL_DB_ENCRYPT	<code>true</code>	TLS to IFL's server.
IFL_DB_TRUST_SERVER_CERTIFICATE	<code>true</code>	Accept a self-signed certificate on IFL's server.
PDAS_WRITE_ENABLED	<code>false</code>	Master switch for the PDAS write path — see section 6.4.
PDAS_WRITE_SERVER / PORT / DATABASE / USER / PASSWORD	—	The separate <code>sms_pdas_writer</code> connection, used only when <code>PDAS_WRITE_ENABLED=true</code> .
PDAS_LIMIT_MAX_SETPOINT_CHANGE_PCT	3	Largest percent a product's target may move in one limits edit before it counts as a large change (tick-box plus a reason of 20+ characters). The developer's default, not IFL's.
PDAS_LIMIT_MAX_OFFSET_CHANGE_G	20	Largest change in grams to either weight limit in one edit before it counts as a large change. The developer's default, not IFL's.
PDAS_WRITE_ENCRYPT / PDAS_WRITE_TRUST_SERVER_CERTIFICATE	<code>true</code>	TLS on the PDAS writer connection.

Key	Default/example	Meaning
SYNC_INTERVAL_SECONDS	60	How often the sync worker runs a pass (minimum 5).
SYNC_OVERLAP_ROWS	500	Watermark overlap window, in rows (minimum 0).
LINE_ID	1	Which line this process serves — immutable once data has been ingested.
SYNC_ONCE	—	Dev/CI single-pass mode.
SYNC_FAILURE_CRITICAL_AFTER	5	Consecutive failed passes before a CRITICAL finding is raised.
SACK_BLACKOUT_HOURS	4	Hours without a new sack row before a WARNING is raised.
PASSWORD_MIN_LENGTH	10	Shortest accepted account password (valid range 6–128).
BACKUP_DIR	C:\sms-backups	Where Health looks for the newest .bak file — must match the backup scripts' own output folder.
RETENTION_SYNC_RUN_DAYS	90	Days of sync-run history kept (newest row per line/table always kept regardless).
RETENTION_DQ_FINDING_DAYS	365	Days of non-CRITICAL data-quality finding history kept.
SIM_DB_NAME / SIM_DB_USER / SIM_DB_PASSWORD	—	Dev-only: the plant simulator's target database and login. Not used on a real installation.
API_PORT	4000	HTTP port the API listens on.
CACHE_TTL_SECONDS	5	In-memory response cache time-to-live.
LINE_NAME	TP1 · Line 3 · Unit 2	Seed-only fallback display name for the line, used only until a line record exists.
LIVE_ALLOW_AS_OF	false	Allows a replay/demo parameter to move the plant clock — must stay false in production.
LIVE_ALLOW_SIMULATOR	false (commented out)	Development PC only; never set at IFL. Lets live screens follow the plant simulator. Ignored unless the database name ends in _SIM and the server is local.
PLANT_UTC_OFFSET_MINUTES	300	The plant's declared UTC offset in minutes (UTC+5 = 300) — see section 1.3.
TRUST_PROXY	false	Whether to trust X-Forwarded-For from a reverse proxy in front of SMS.
COOKIE_SECURE	true	Secure flag on the session cookie — must be false on a plain-HTTP LAN.

Key	Default/example	Meaning
TLS_PFX_PATH / TLS_PFX_PASSPHRASE	—	Direct TLS termination, PFX form.
TLS_CERT_PATH / TLS_KEY_PATH	—	Direct TLS termination, certificate/key file form.
WEB_DIST	./web/dist	When set, the API also serves the built web app from this path — the normal production setup.
WEIGHT_BASIS	as_recorded	Cone/sack weight interpretation (as_recorded, gross or net) — not fully confirmed by IFL; see Appendix C, item 12.
CONE_TUBE_WEIGHT_G	70	Tube tare weight, used only under the net basis — a developer placeholder, not IFL-confirmed.
SACK_TARE_KG	0.5	Sack tare weight, used only under the net basis.
SHIFT_MODE	corrected	Shift-boundary basis (corrected or legacy) — see Appendix C, item 12.
SHIFT_NIGHT_BELONGS_TO	start_day	Night-shift attribution rule (start_day or calendar_day).
PLC_READER_ENABLED, PLC_HOST, PLC_RACK, PLC_SLOT, PLC_CONE_ID_DB	false / placeholders	The still-deferred direct PLC reader — see Appendix C, item 1. None of these keys is read by any current code path; they exist only as a documented, dependency-free re-entry point.
PDF_EDGE_PATH	—	Explicit path to msedge.exe, if PDF export cannot find Edge at its default install location.

Five further keys tune connection-pool and request-timeout behaviour with safe built-in defaults and are not in .env.example: API_DB_POOL_MAX (10), API_DB_POOL_MIN (1), API_DB_POOL_IDLE_TIMEOUT_MS (30000), API_DB_REQUEST_TIMEOUT_MS (30000), and PDAS_MIRROR_REFRESH_SECONDS (600, minimum 5) — leave these unset unless a specific performance problem calls for tuning them.

There is no SESSION_SECRET key: sessions are server-side random identifiers, not signed tokens, so there is nothing for such a key to sign.

B Command reference

All commands below run from the package root (C:\sms once installed) unless stated otherwise. Arguments use --key=value; a bare space-separated --flag value is not accepted.

B.1 The CLI — node cli/dist/index.js <command> [flags]

Command	Purpose
sync	Runs one full read-transform-write pass. Halts and exits 1 on an unregistered source generation or a partial failure.
verify [--weights] [--from=YYYY-MM-DD --to=YYYY-MM-DD] [--source-db=<name> --epoch=<id>[,<id>]]	Reconciles the app database against the source, per generation. Exits 1 on any mismatch. --source-db checks a backfilled generation against an archive database and needs --epoch.
summary [--date=YYYY-MM-DD] [--shift=<text>] [--epoch=N[,M]]	Prints one block per source generation covering the date. Read-only, always exits 0.
rebuild --table=<cone_event sack_event reject_event> --snapshot-id=<id> (--epoch=N[,M] --all-generations) --confirm	Deletes and re-derives canonical rows for one table and scope. Prints a plan first; without --confirm, exits 2 and changes nothing.
cutover --confirm --backup=<path.bak>	Clears canonical and raw readings ahead of a cutover from a test copy to the live plant. --backup=<path.bak> is required — a bare --confirm with no backup flag is refused at exit 2, even though DEPLOY.md's own shorthand omits it. Preserves accounts, product timeline, rule history and the audit log.
retention [--dry-run]	Prunes old sms.sync_run and non-CRITICAL sms.dq_finding rows only — never readings, the audit log, or the product-change history.
user:create --username=<u> --password=<p> --role=<viewer engineer manager admin> [--display=<name>]	Creates an account. Role must be exactly viewer, engineer, manager or admin.
user:password --username=<u> --password=<new password>	Resets a password and revokes every session for that account.
epoch:list	Lists every registered source generation with its row counts and time range.
epoch:accept (--all --table=<sourceTable>) --confirm --provenance=<ifl_live ifl_copy simulator> [--label="..."]	Registers a source generation. Two-step: run once without --confirm to see the plan, then re-run identically with --confirm added. --provenance is required for a new registration. It refuses a restored old archive posing as a new generation; --i-know-this-is-a-new-generation overrides that, audited, only on the maintainer's instruction.
epoch:backfill (--table=<sourceTable> --all) --epoch=<id> --source-db=<archive database> [--confirm] [--sampled]	Adds older rows to the end of a closed generation's raw tables. Dry run without --confirm (exit 2, nothing changed). Refuses everything on any failed check. Proven only on scratch copies; IFL's real archive has not been sent. Run rebuild afterwards.

Command	Purpose
epoch:purge --epoch=N[,M] --confirm --backup=<path.bak>	Deletes rows for closed generation(s), keeping the generation record itself as a tombstone. Same backup gate as cutover.
epoch:drop --epoch=N --confirm	Deletes a generation record entirely — only if it holds no rows; use epoch:purge first otherwise.

B.2 npm scripts (from the package root)

Script	Does
npm run build:shared	Builds the shared workspace only.
npm run typecheck	Type-checks every workspace.
npm test	Runs the test suite.
npm run test:layout	Runs the browser layout tests (developers).
npm run db:migrate	Applies every pending database migration.
npm run build	Builds every workspace in dependency order (shared, sync-worker, cli, api, web).
npm run verify:release	typecheck + test + build, together.

B.3 sms\scripts*.ps1

Script	Purpose
backup-appdb.ps1 -Server <host,port> -Db sms -Pass <password> -OutDir <dir>	Nightly checksummed backup of the app database only. -User "" uses a trusted Windows connection instead of a SQL login/password — what the scheduled task itself uses. Writes a .verified.json marker beside a backup that passes RESTORE VERIFYONLY, and renames one that fails to .unverified. Deletes .bak files (and markers) older than 30 days in -OutDir unless -NoPrune is given.
backup-config.ps1 -InstallDir C:\sms -BackupDir C:\sms-backups	Copies .env, TLS material, service definitions and scheduled-task XML into an ACL-locked folder — never the database itself. Must run as administrator.
install-scheduled-tasks.ps1 -InstallDir C:\sms -RunAs <account> -BackupDir C:\sms-backups [-WhatIf]	Registers the three production scheduled tasks: nightly backup, weekly database maintenance, daily retention. -WhatIf previews without registering.

B.4 sqlcmd and Windows commands used during installation

Purpose	Command
Create the app database and its logins	sqlcmd -S <server\instance> -E -i db\bootstrap\00_create_app_database.sql -v AppPassword="..." -v MigratePassword="..."
Open the API port	netsh advfirewall firewall add rule name="SMS API" dir=in action=allow protocol=TCP localport=4000
Weekly database maintenance	sqlcmd -S .\SQLEXPRESS -E -d sms -b -i scripts\db-maintenance.sql

Purpose	Command
Check/run a scheduled task	<code>schtasks /query /tn "SMS Nightly Backup" /v /fo LIST,schtasks /run /tn "SMS Nightly Backup"</code>
Wall-mode kiosk browser	<code>msedge --kiosk http://<plant-ip>:4000/?s=wall --edge-kiosk-type=fullscreen</code>

Warning: DEPLOY.md's own shorthand for cutover, `sms cutover --confirm`, omits the required `--backup=<path.bak>` flag and is refused by the code. Always include `--backup=<path.bak>`.

C Known limitations

These are current, known limitations of SMS — not bugs waiting to be fixed before go-live, but honest statements of what the system does and does not do today.

1. **No PLC integration.** SMS reads from SQL Server only. A direct connection to the line's PLCs was scoped out by IFL's own decision; the `.env` keys for it exist only as a disabled, dependency-free re-entry point, read by no code path today.
2. **Sack stock per machine is not computable.** IFL's sack data carries no machine or station column — only the sack number, weight, in-range flag and insert time. The **Sacks** screen states this on screen rather than guessing.
3. **PDAS writes are off, and the plant writer login is not yet provisioned.** See section 6.4. The nine write actions have been proven against a non-production copy; none has ever run against the plant itself. Who at IFL may make limit changes, whether that needs a higher permission than the engineer role, and the size of change that counts as large (3 % or 20 g, the developer's numbers) are all still open.
4. **A changeover does not select the product on a machine.** It only makes a product selectable in PDAS. Whether a machine's own controller reads its limits from PDAS live is a separate, still-open question for IFL.
5. **The data is always some minutes old.** See section 1.2 — roughly 18 minutes, measured from IFL's own acquisition layer, not an SMS delay.
6. **Two separate clocks.** Production timestamps are the plant's own wall clock labelled UTC; everything SMS itself writes is genuine UTC — see section 1.3. Never assume the two match without conversion.
7. **Planned breaks and faults cannot be told apart** in the source data. No downtime reason code exists; time-lost figures on the Report screen carry this caveat.
8. **A real gap exists in the historical data supplied so far** (26 days, 10 July to 5 August), not yet filled by IFL. Nothing in SMS substitutes for the missing data; a data-quality check flags a production day that could plausibly sit inside this kind of gap. A tool to load it once it arrives exists (`epoch:backfill`) but has been proven only on scratch copies.
9. **One line is served per API process today.** Serving several lines from one installation is follow-on work, pending an IFL decision on whether more than one line is in scope.
10. **SQL Server Express caps a single database file at 10 GB.** **Health** reports the current size against this cap and raises a warning past 80% full. How long readings should be retained against this cap is IFL's own decision, not yet made.
11. **Only one calibration pattern rule is shown, deliberately.** The further seven Nelson rules were evaluated and rejected by measurement — they flagged an unworkably large share of stations on real data, because station weight readings are naturally autocorrelated from one reading to the next. **Health** and the Weight screen state this rather than silently omitting the rules.
12. **Weight basis and the shift-boundary rule are not fully confirmed by IFL.** The app states "not confirmed" wherever this matters; do not change `WEIGHT_BASIS` or `SHIFT_MODE` without a written answer from IFL.
13. **No email alerting,** because the plant PC is air-gapped. `GET /api/health` is meant to be polled by whatever monitoring tool the plant already runs.
14. **Retention of raw and canonical readings is undecided.** Nothing prunes readings automatically today; at the measured accumulation rate this is not urgent, but it remains IFL's decision to make.
15. **"Reports with graphics" is a requirement still being matched against what is built.** PDF, Excel and CSV export exist, with tables and charts rendered into the PDF — whether this fully satisfies IFL's own expectation is being tracked, not assumed closed.

16. **Not every elevated-rank route has an automated client/server rank cross-check.** The mechanical check covers only about 6 of roughly 25 to 32 elevated-rank routes; the rest are verified by reading the code rather than by a mechanical test, a lower bar of proof, worth knowing if a future change touches access control.
17. **No off-machine backup of IFL's own source data exists yet,** beyond what this guide's own section 9.1 section covers for the app database. Both of IFL's data samples, and every copy of the SMS deliverable itself, currently live on a single machine — an operational risk for IFL to accept or remedy, not a defect in SMS's own code.
18. **Backups are proven, not yet unattended.** The backup script checks each file and writes a marker Health reads. It has been run by hand once. The nightly schedule has not run unattended, and no copy leaves this one PC.
19. **SMS shifts can differ from IFL's vendor screen.** SMS works shifts out from production time; the vendor's Shift column uses insert time. Reports carry a footnote. Which is right for IFL is an open question.
20. **A wrong time zone only warns.** If the PC's time zone does not match `PLANT_UTC_OFFSET_MINUTES`, SMS logs a warning but still starts.
21. **Rules are read as "current", not "in force".** Weight and plausibility rules apply as they are now; shift-rule history is honoured for range edges since 29 September 2026, but rows transformed earlier keep their old shift.
22. **A recorded weight of exactly 0 is unexplained.** Two real IFL rows are zero. What a zero means is a question for IFL. They keep Health at "degraded" until an engineer acknowledges them.
23. **A sign-in failure can hide a database problem.** The generic sign-in error is shown for a wrong password and for some database-connection failures.
24. **Go-live conditions are still open.** The software is ready for a supervised pilot, not unattended production: read-only logins for both databases, services and backups proven on the target PC, an off-machine copy, a two-week parallel run, and written answers from IFL are all outstanding.
25. **The print/PDF layout has a real automated test harness, but no case needing a signed-in session has been run through it yet** for want of a dedicated test account and credentials.
26. **No one has yet signed in as a viewer-rank account on a live instance.** Rank-1 rendering is proven by an automated test against a simulated sign-in, not by an actual person's session — worth confirming once IFL has created a viewer account.

D Sign-off sheet

Use this sheet to record that installation was completed and verified. Keep a signed copy with IFL's own records.

D.1 Installation

- ☐ Prerequisites confirmed (section 4.1)
- ☐ Read-only login obtained from IFL's DBA (section 4.2)
- ☐ App database and logins created (section 4.3)
- ☐ .env created and filled in (section 4.4)
- ☐ Build completed with no errors (section 4.5)
- ☐ Migrations applied (section 4.6)
- ☐ First admin account created (section 4.7)
- ☐ Manager/engineer accounts created (section 4.8)
- ☐ Windows services registered and running (section 4.9)
- ☐ Firewall rule added (section 4.10)
- ☐ First sync completed, generation accepted, verify clean (section 4.11)
- ☐ Scheduled tasks registered (section 4.12)
- ☐ Wall display configured, if in scope (section 4.13)

D.2 Verification

- ☐ Every item in section 5 ticked off
- ☐ A backup has run and been confirmed restorable (section 9.1)
- ☐ Sign-in tested for at least one account of each role in use

D.3 Sign-off

Field	
Installed by (name)	_____
Installed by (signature)	_____
Date	_____
Confirmed by IFL (name)	_____
Confirmed by IFL (signature)	_____
Date	_____

Note: Signing this sheet confirms only that the installation and verification checklists above were completed; the known limitations in Appendix C stay open items for IFL and the maintainer.